

A Table-Top Roleplaying Game

# RESONANCE

DAVID BEALL



**Special Thanks to Inge, Riley, Emmy and Iris**

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## Foreword: A Layered Learning Experience

Welcome to the Resonance system. This System Reference Document (SRD) contains the complete, authoritative rules for the Resonance system.

The rule book is a layered experience, designed to teach the game in escalating steps of complexity. The entire system is built on a single, unified concept: using dice rolls to deplete Clocks.

### Document Overview

**Layer 1: The Dice and Objectives.** Introduces the Standard Roll, Clocks and situation clock, Target Numbers and the Episode Downtime cycle.

**Layer 2: The Situation and Actions.** Introduces your character's resource Clocks, the challenges you'll face, the actions you can take, and the Situation Clock that tracks immediate progress.

**Layer 3: Tactical Modifiers.** Adds temporary states and effects that modify the core gameplay.

**Layer 4: The Strategic Game.** Reveals the full, nested clock hierarchy, details different Situation Types

**Layer 5: Entities Items and Progression.** Provides rules for entity and item stats, clocks, growth and advanced Karma usage.

**Appendix A: The full Keyword list with definitions**

**Appendix B: The Philosophy for building your world**

**Appendix C: The Blueprint of Creation**

**The Archive: A Rogue-Lite Game Mode**

**And Additional Aides and Guides !**

## Glossary of Core Concepts

Welcome to the Resonance system! The world is built on a few core ideas. Understanding these key terms will make learning the game much easier.

- **Clock:** The central mechanic of the game. A Clock is a resource tracker (like a health bar) that you are trying to deplete to 0. Your character has personal Clocks (HP, SP, EP), and challenges have their own Clocks (Task Clock, Situation Clock).
- **Standard Roll (SR):** The result of your dice roll. You roll two ten-sided dice (2d10), and the result is typically the number on your designated "Main Die," unless you roll doubles.
- **Effect Value (EV):** Your total "attack" score when trying to affect another entity. It's calculated by adding your SR + your Level + a chosen Stat. Your goal is to have your EV beat a target's Resistance.
- **Effort Roll (ER):** Your total "skill" score when trying to overcome a non-combat challenge, like picking a lock or persuading a guard. It's calculated the same way as an EV: SR + Level + Stat. Your goal is to have your ER beat a challenge's Target Number.
- **Resistance:** An entity's primary defense value. It's calculated by adding their three highest stats together.
- **Target Number (TN):** The difficulty of a non-combat challenge. This is the number you need to beat with an Effort Roll.
- **Keyword:** The fundamental building block of all special abilities. Each keyword grants a unique active, passive, or gear-based effect that allows you to bend or break the core rules. Learning new keywords is how you level up.
- **Tag:** A temporary effect on a character, gained from keywords or other abilities. There are two types:
  - **Status Tag:** A negative effect (like Weaken or Blight) that is usually triggered automatically.
  - **Boost Tag:** A positive effect (like Haste or Ward) that you can choose when to use.
- **Situation:** A single, self-contained encounter or challenge, like a combat, a tense negotiation, or a complex trap. Successfully resolving a Situation is how you advance the overall story.
- **Animation:** A simplified entity, often a creature, minion, or construct, controlled by the GM or a player.
- **Karma:** A special resource earned through good roleplaying and succeeding in Situations. It can be spent to reroll dice, learn new abilities, or influence the story in powerful ways.

## Layer 1 : The Dice and Objectives

This first layer contains the absolute essential mechanics needed to play the game at its most basic level.

### 1.0 : The Standard Roll (SR)

The Core Roll: All actions are resolved with a Standard Roll (SR).

(1.1) Roll two ten-sided dice (2d10). Designate one as the Main Die and the other as the Lucky Die. Your result is the number on the Main Die, unless both dice show the same number (a "double").

(1.2) Chaining Doubles: If you roll doubles during any roll that requires an SR, add their combined total (e.g., 14) to a running total and roll both dice again. Repeat this process for any subsequent doubles. Your final SR is the sum of all chained doubles plus the final, non-double result from your Main Die.

(1.3) Advantage & Disadvantage: With Advantage, use the higher of the two dice for your non-double result. With Disadvantage, use the lower. This only applies to the final roll in a chain.

(1.4) Criticals: Any double is also a Critical. A Critical can also apply one of the following options.

- Edge (cutting/tearing effects): Apply Weaken Tag
- Point (piercing/penetrating effects): Apply Blight Tag
- Surface (blunt/impact effects): Apply Daze Tag
- Restore (healing or value recovery effects): Restore the target clock to its maximum or revive an eligible target
- Damage: Any clock decrease caused by this effect is doubled.

(1.5) An effect is considered successful if it meets any of the following conditions:

- It causes a change in the targeted clock (HP, SP, or EP)
- It applies a tag (such as Weaken, Blight, or Daze)
- It imposes movement or a condition (e.g., knockback, stunned, silenced)

(1.6) An effect is considered a miss only if the initial roll is made with Disadvantage and the lower of the two dice is a 1. This represents a catastrophic fumble or clear misfire.

- A miss always fails, regardless of total EV or target Resistance.
- Misses do not apply value loss, keywords, tags, or effects of any kind.

*Example: A character makes an effect roll with Disadvantage and rolls a 1 and a 6. The result is 1, which causes the effect to miss entirely, even if the final EV would have exceeded Resistance.*

(1.7) When a character achieves a final Standard Roll (SR) result of 31 or higher, it is a Super Critical.

(1.8) In addition to the critical effects of the action, a Super Critical grants the following benefit:

- Heroics: Immediately remove 1 point from the current Situation Clock. This represents an act of legendary prowess that quickly overcomes the situation.

## 2.0: Depleting Clocks: The Core Mechanic

Your goal is to deplete a target's Clock to 0. If your roll exceeds the Target Number (TN) you deplete the targeted clock by the difference.

(2.1) Progressing the Scene (vs. The Situation): Any clock you resolve depletes the situation clock by 1.

(2.1.1) Target Defense (vs. Entities): Your Effect Value (EV) ('SR + Level + Stat') must exceed the target's Resistance ('Sum of 3 highest Stats'). The difference between the EV and Resistance is the amount the targeted clock is reduced

(2.1.2) Challenge Difficulty (vs. non Entity Clocks): Your Effort Roll ('SR + Level + Stat') must exceed the challenge's Target Number (TN). The difference in the Effort Roll and TN is the amount the targeted clock is reduced.

(2.2) A clock is resolved when it reaches 0

(2.3) When the Situation Clock reaches 0 the Situation reaches its endpoint.

(2.4) The length of a Clock determines how much effort is required to resolve a challenge.

Use the following table as a guideline to set the starting value for Task Clocks based on the narrative complexity of the challenge.

| Difficulty  | Suggested Length | Example                                |
|-------------|------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Trivial     | 1-2              | A simple lock.                         |
| Easy        | 3-4              | A skeptical guard.                     |
| Average     | 5-7              | A complex mechanism.                   |
| Difficult   | 8-10             | An interrogation of a hostile witness. |
| Challenging | 11-14            | Swaying a council's vote.              |
| Heroic      | 15+              | Breaching a fortress wall.             |

(2.5) Using Clocks in Play:

- Binary Checks: For simple, pass/fail tasks, a Clock of 1 is often sufficient. If the player's Effort Roll exceeds the TN, the task is complete.
- Complex Tasks: Longer Clocks are excellent for representing multi-stage challenges that require teamwork or repeated effort over time. Each successful Effort Roll chips away at the problem until it is solved.
- GM Discretion: These numbers are a guide, not a rigid rule. As the Curator of Play, you should always feel empowered to adjust Clock lengths up or down to match the pacing and tension of the scene.

*Example: The heroes need to get through a heavy, barred oak door. The GM decides this is an 'Easy' challenge. Consulting the tables, they set the Target Number (TN) to 6 and the door's Task Clock to 4. The players will need to make one or more successful Effort Rolls to accumulate at least 4 points of progress to break down the door.*

## 3.0: Target Numbers (TN)

The TN represents the difficulty of the task. A player must roll equal to or higher than the TN to succeed.



(3.1) A reference list of TNs to set difficulty:

- 3 - Trivial
- 6 - Easy
- 9 - Average
- 12 - Difficult
- 15 - Challenging
- 18+ - Heroic

*The TN is a GM's primary tool for communicating the scale of a challenge. For example, if heroes face a wide chasm, setting the TN to jump across at a Heroic \*\*18\*\* signals that a simple roll is not the intended solution. This high TN encourages players to look for creative alternatives, like pushing over a nearby pillar. The GM can then present this new, more interesting task with a manageable \*\*Average TN of 9\*\*, rewarding the players' ingenuity and guiding the narrative without saying a word.*

## 4.0: Story Structure

The Story is the overarching narrative, composed of two main phases: Episodes and Downtime

(4.1) Episode: This is the active, story-driven periods of play. During an Episode, characters interact with the world, undertake actions, and confront challenges.

(4.2) An Episode consists of a smaller unit referred to as Scenes (3 is Average).

(4.3) Scenes are comprised of any combination of the following to establish an arc or major chapter of an episode:

- Travel, which covers journeys or movement within the episode.,
- Situations, which are high-stakes encounters such as combat or tense social conflicts, and challenges
- Rests, which are brief opportunities for recovery.

(4.4) Downtime: This is a longer period between episodes focused on rest, recovery, and long-term advancement. During Downtime, characters fully recover their resources and may engage in crafting, training, or managing narrative choices.

## 5.0: Priority and Turn Order

At the beginning of a situation that requires turn order to be tracked, the player who is currently acting or the character that wins the initiative has priority for the first round and may take their actions.

(5.1) Initiative is won by the character with the highest Wit stat.

(5.2) If the Result is a Tie, the tiebreaker can be either an opposed SR with the highest result gaining priority, or the character with the highest Alacrity.

(5.3) Once the character has completed all of their actions, or when they decide, their turn is ended and priority is passed.

(5.4) Priority passes to an ally of the acting player's choice as long as they had a successful action during their turn.

(5.5) Priority is passed to an Enemy if the player did not have a successful action on their turn, the enemy chosen is the enemy that was targeted by the failed action.

(5.6) When all participants in the situation have taken their turn, and used or declined their allotted actions per turn this concludes the round.

(5.7) A character can only receive one turn per round unless another effect specifically grants them Priority whilst they have available unspent actions.

## 6.0: Surprise

When a group or individual initiates a combat against unaware targets they gain surprise for the first round.

- (6.1) Surprise is gained when the targeted group is unaware of the incoming effects.
- (6.2) The Surprised entities have Disadvantage on all Reactions during the first round
- (6.3) Entities that are surprised also cannot gain priority on the first round until all the surprising entities have taken their turn for the round.

### MEET SPARKS: OUR EXAMPLE CHARACTER

To help illustrate how these rules work, let's create a character named Sparks. We'll follow her journey as she grows from a novice adventurer into a capable hero.

#### The Seed (Level 0)

Sparks' journey begins at Level 0. All of her stats (Movement, Brawn, Wit, etc.) have a value of 1. The first and most important choice we make is her Seed Keyword, which defines her core potential. We've chosen Attuned (1.3) for Sparks. This means she has a deep, innate connection to a specific person or object. Let's say she carries an old, dented compass that belonged to her grandfather, and this is the object she is attuned to.

#### Sparks in Action: Her First Roll

Sparks is trying to get through a magically locked door. The GM decides this is a simple Environmental Challenge with a Target Number (TN) of 9. Sparks decides to channel her innate energy into her attuned compass, hoping its connection to her grandfather's adventurous spirit can bypass the lock.

This requires an Effort Roll. The formula is  $SR + \text{Level} + \text{Stat}$ .

Alex, Sparks' player, rolls 2d10 for a Standard Roll (SR). The dice land on an 8 (Main Die) and a 3 (Lucky Die). Her SR is 8.

The GM asks Alex which Stat she wants to use. Alex says, "I'm focusing my inner will, so I'll use my Force stat. *(All her stats are 1 so the choice is based on the narrative)*"

Alex calculates her total Effort Roll:  $9 \text{ (SR)} + 0 \text{ (Level)} + 1 \text{ (Force Stat)} = 10$ .

Her result of 10 exceeds the TN of 9! The magical lock sputters and clicks open. Since her roll exceeded the TN by 1, the door's "Clock" *(which was just 1 in this simple case as a binary check)* is reduced to 0. Sparks has overcome her first challenge.

## Layer 2: The Situation and Actions

This layer introduces your character's resources, the choices you can make, and the immediate structure of an encounter

### 1.0: Your Character's Clocks (Resources)

You have three personal Clocks. You must prevent these from being depleted.

(1.1) Health Points (HP): Your physical durability. Starts at 10. Depleted by damage.

(1.2) Stamina Points (SP): Your physical exertion. Starts at 10. Depleted by strenuous actions.

(1.3) Energy Points (EP): Your inner power. Starts at 10. Depleted by using innate abilities.

### 2.0: Environmental Challenges (Micro-Clocks)

In addition to Entities (living beings with HP, SP, and EP Clocks), you will face three distinct types of Environmental Challenges.

(2.1) Barrier: a physical or magical obstruction that must be worn down or broken through.

(2.1.1)Mechanic: A Barrier is defined by a Task Clock and a Target Number (TN). The TN is typically  $10 + \text{the Barrier's Level}$ .

(2.1.2)Interaction: Players use 'Effort Rolls' to deplete the Barrier's Task Clock.

(2.2) Puzzle: a cerebral challenge that requires logic or insight. It is not depleted with repeated rolls.

(2.2.1)Mechanic: A Puzzle is binary (solved or unsolved) and defined by a single, high Target Number (TN).

(2.2.2)Interaction: Players overcome a Puzzle through roleplaying. The GM may call for a single, decisive Effort Roll against the Puzzle's TN to see if their solution works.

(2.3) Traps (Environmental Hazards) An Item with keywords placed in the environment to create a hazard. A trap is defined by three components: The Payload, The Trigger, and The Challenge

(2.3.1) The Payload (The Item): The trap itself is an item that produces an effect. When triggered, it uses the Activate action to release its keywords.

(2.3.2) The Trigger (Narrative): The narrative event that causes the Payload to Activate. This is set by the GM (e.g., a pressure plate, a failed roll to disarm its mechanism).

(2.3.3)The Challenge (The Mechanics): The challenge that players must overcome to prevent the trap from triggering. This is almost always a Barrier or a Puzzle.

### 3.0: The Situation Clock

An encounter or phase of an Scene is called a Situation. It is represented by a Situation Clock.

(3.1) The Situation Clock's starting value is equal to the number of key Micro-Clocks (Entities, Barriers, Puzzles) within it.

(3.2) When you deplete any HP or Task Clock to 0, or solve a Puzzle, you deplete 1 point from the parent Situation Clock.

(3.3) Depleting a Situation Clock to 0 reduces the Scene Clock by 1.

### 4.0: The Action Catalog

The following is a complete list of actions available to a character, organized by type.



(4.1) A character begins with a set number of actions they can take on their turn (Alacrity Stat). This number can be modified by keywords or other effects.

(4.2) A character can never take more than 6 total actions on their turn.

### **Curator's Tip: The Three Core Choices**

For faster play, especially with new players, you can boil down the entire Action Catalog into three core questions a player can ask on their turn. Almost every action falls into one of these categories.

“Do I want to CHANGE something?”

This is an Activate action (attacking, using an ability) or an Effort Roll (overcoming a barrier). The goal is to directly affect an enemy or the environment.

“Do I want to CONTROL the battlefield?”

This is a Maneuver (Shove, Taunt, Disarm). The goal isn't to deal damage, but to change the tactical situation by moving enemies or applying conditions.

“Do I want to PREPARE for the future?”

This is a Focus action (gaining Advantage, learning a Clue) or a Teamwork action (buffing an ally). The goal is to sacrifice this turn's action for a bigger advantage on a future turn.

By framing their turn with these three simple questions a player can quickly decide on their intent, which makes choosing a specific action from the catalog much faster and more intuitive.

### **(4.3) Effect Actions (Single Action)**

1. Activate: The primary action for causing an effect. The base roll for an Activate action is called an Effort Value (EV).

- The EV is calculated by adding a Standard Roll, The Character's Level, and the Character's Chosen Stat.
- Keyword Active Effects can be applied for a cost of one EP per keyword.
- The total EP cost is reduced by the character's Power Stat.
- If the EV does not exceed the target's Resistance, the Action has no effect unless a keyword states otherwise.

2. Called Shot: You make a specialized Activate action with Disadvantage to target a specific weak point on an enemy Character or to target an item they are holding.

- Targeting an Item: A successful hit deals value loss to the item's Durability Clock instead of the wielder's HP. The wielder defends with their normal Resistance.
- Targeting an Entity: A successful Called Shot against an Entity is automatically a Critical Hit, even if doubles are not rolled, granting you the choice of its bonus effects. If this attack reduces the target's HP Clock to 0, they are killed instantly, bypassing the normal Unconscious state (unless a passive keyword or other effect prevents this).

### **(4.4) Move Actions (Single Action)**

1. Move: Travel up to a number of range bands equal to your Movement stat.
2. Mount: Perform an Interact action to gain the Riding condition on a valid target.

3. Dismount: Perform an Interact action to end the Riding condition.
4. Hide: Make an `Effort Roll' (SR + Level + Stat) to become Hidden. The result is the TN to find you.

#### (4.5) Maneuver Actions (Single Action, costs 1 SP)

1. Shove: Make an EV roll vs. target's Resistance to push them or knock them Prone.
2. Disarm: Make an opposed EV roll to force a target to drop an item.
3. Restrain: Make an EV roll to grant the Bind Tag to a target.
4. Lunge: Make a melee strike that can target an enemy at Close range instead of Touch range.
5. Lock On: Gain Advantage against a target, who also gains Advantage against you.
6. Taunt: Make an opposed EV roll to force a target to use Lock On against you.
7. Improvise: Use the environment or an item to apply a Status Tag without dealing value loss.
8. Multi-Attack: When making an attack action, for an additional 1 SP, you may add the Level and one keyword from a second equipped item to your effect. You must pay the normal EP cost (if any) for the added keyword.
9. Feint: Make an opposed EV roll to make the target Exposed.

#### (4.6) Focus & Assess Actions (Full Turn Action, costs 1 SP)

1. Recharge: Restore EP equal to your Power stat or Restore SP equal to your Brawn Stat. *(The cost remains so this action can't be taken with 0 stamina)*
2. Recover: Remove a number of Tags of your choice equal to either Brawn, Wit, or Influence from your Tag pool.
3. Ready: Add your Wit stat to your Resistance value until the start of your next turn.
4. Advantage: Gain Advantage on the first SR you make on your next turn.
5. Reveal: Make an Effort Roll against a Hidden target's Hide roll to locate and target them.
6. Clue: Learn a number of facts about a target equal to your Technique stat.

#### (4.7) Effort & Team Actions (Single Action)

1. Effort Roll: The primary action for targeting a Barrier's Task Clock or solving a Puzzle.
2. Teamwork: Grant a stat of your choice as a bonus to an ally's next Effort Roll.
3. Sabotage: A target suffers Disadvantage on their next Effort Roll.

#### (4.8) Reaction Actions (Triggered outside your turn)

1. Avoid (Dodge) (1 SP): Make an opposed EV roll to negate an incoming effect. If the EV is higher than the incoming EV, ignore the effect.
2. Resist (Block) (1 SP): Add your Level to your Resistance against a single incoming effect.
3. Parry (3 SP): Negate an effect entirely and immediately gain Priority.
4. Clash (2 SP): Use your own effect to intercept another; the loser takes the combined value loss.
5. Reflect (1 SP): After a successful Avoid or Resist, redirect the original effect back at the attacker.
6. Counter (1 SP): After a successful Avoid or Resist, make an immediate Activate action.
7. Guard (1 SP, Ally Reaction): Intercept an attack targeting an ally, become the target of the effect and allowing you to react if able. The ally must be within close.

8. Combo (1 SP, Ally Reaction): Add a stat of your choice and one of your known keywords to an ally's effect.
9. Flank (1 SP, Ally Reaction): If an ally attacks an enemy adjacent to you, grant that enemy Disadvantage on their next action.

#### (4.9) Setup & Command Actions (Single Action)

1. Reload: Required by the 'Material' keyword; consumes an item.
2. Assist: Designate one target. All allies gain Advantage on their next action against that target.
3. Pass: End your turn, ceding Priority.
4. Command: Direct a Companion, Animation, or Mount under your control to act.

## 5.0: Effort

Social challenges, skill challenges, and any non-combat challenge are resolved using Effort Rolls against a Target Number (TN) and a Clock.

#### (5.3) Effort Roll Mechanics

- Roll a Standard Roll (SR) ; use Advantage/Disadvantage if applicable.
- ER (Effort Roll) = SR + Chosen Stat + Level
- Keywords or other effects are then applied to the EV
- Subtract TN from the EV and reduce the Clock by the amount if it is positive.

#### (5.4) Social challenges are an Effort Roll Shaped by 3 Criteria

(5.4.1) Faction Trust: The social status of the character with the target's associated faction or group determines advantage or disadvantage.

- Ally - Advantage
- Neutral - Standard Roll
- Enemy - Disadvantage

(5.4.2) Character Trust: The personal level of trust and respect for the character from the target determines the TN

- Trusting - TN 5
- Neutral - TN 8
- Doubting - TN 12

(5.4.3) Tension: The urgency of the situation that merited the need for the Social Challenge.

- Calm - Clock = 3
- Neutral - Clock = 5
- Tense - Clock = 10

(5.4.4) Success of a social challenge is decided by reducing the clock to 0.

(5.5) Non combat and non social challenges follow the same core mechanic: Effort Roll vs. TN and Clock.

(5.5.1) The TN and Clock are determined entirely by the narrative stakes and task complexity and are set by the GM.

(5.5.2) Success is measured by reducing the clock to 0 through accumulated effort and is based on the narrative the GM has set

(5.5.3) Binary challenges do not use a clock and are successful as long as the ER exceeds the TN

## 6.0: Stat Application (Player's Choice)

Many actions and keywords in the Resonance system allow a character to add a stat to a roll.

- (6.1) The player always chooses which of their nine stats to apply to the roll.
- (6.2) The player should briefly justify their choice based on their description of the action.
- (6.3) Keywords and rules may require a specific stat instead of player choice and will specify as such.
- (6.3) The Game Master has the final say on the appropriateness of a stat, but the default assumption is always to empower the player's choice.

## 7.0: Defeat, Death, and Resurrection

Managing your resource Clocks is key to survival. Allowing them to be fully depleted can have dire consequences.

- (7.1) When your primary Clock (HP) is reduced to 0, you are considered Downed. You immediately suffer the associated Condition (Unconscious)
  - (7.1.1) A Downed character is not defeated and can still be restored or affected as normal.
  - (7.2) While you are at 0 HP (Unconscious), any further effect that would cause you to lose HP is lethal. Your character is dead, unless a passive keyword or other effect states otherwise.
  - (7.3) Bringing a character back from death is a monumental task. It can be achieved in one of two ways:
    - (7.3.1) Miraculous Restoration: An ally scores a Critical while using a Restore effect on your character during the same situation that caused the character to be Downed.
    - (7.3.2) Emergency Care: A character can make a singular attempt to resuscitate a down character with the following criteria:
      - A dead character can only be attempted to be resurrected with emergency care once during the Scene they were downed during.
      - The roll is made as a SR + The acting characters Level
      - The TN of the roll is the Target's maximum HP + the Number of rounds they have been Dead.
      - A successful roll results in an alive but still Downed Character with all clocks set to 0.
      - A failed roll results in the character requiring Downtime to be resurrected.
    - (7.3.3) Downtime: The party performs a special activity during a Downtime phase, often requiring a significant Karma expenditure or the completion of a difficult side-quest, as determined by the GM.

### SPARKS IN ACTION: THE AWAKENING

After overcoming her first challenge, the GM rules that Sparks has had her Awakening. This is a major narrative event that transforms her from a Level 0 "Seed" into a Level 1 hero.

The Awakening (Level 1)

Level Up: Sparks is now Level 1.

Stat Growth: All nine of her stats increase from 1 to a new baseline of 2.

New Keywords: She immediately learns three new keywords. To build on her "Attuned" theme of connection and utility, her player, Alex, chooses:

Traveler (1.1): Alex chooses Teleport as her movement type. She can now instantly relocate to a visible location.

Insightful (8.3): This allows her to sense emotions and detect lies, reinforcing her theme of perception and connection.

Trickster (9.3): This gives her the ability to create minor sensory illusions, a clever way to use her powers non-violently.

Sparks' Level 1 Stats:

Level: 1

Stats: All stats are 2.

HP/SP/EP: 10/10/10

Resistance: 6 (sum of her three highest stats, which are all 2)

Her First Situation

Sparks enters a warehouse and finds two Level 1 Thugs (Animations) threatening a merchant. The GM declares a Situation with a Situation Clock of 2 (one for each Thug).

Rook's Turn: Rook, Sparks' ally, defeats one Thug. The Situation Clock is now 1.

Sparks' Turn: It's Sparks' turn, and she has 2 actions (from her Alacrity stat).

The remaining Thug has a Resistance of 3.

Action 1 (Activate): Alex declares, "I want to use my Trickster ability to create the illusion of a guard dog barking behind the Thug to distract him." She will Activate this effect, targeting the Thug's EP (mental stamina).

Keywords & Cost: To make this work, she applies the Trickster (9.3) keyword. This costs 1 EP, which is then reduced by her Power stat of 2. The final cost is 0 EP (min 0).

The Roll: She rolls a 6 on her SR.

The Calculation: Alex chooses to use her Influence stat. Her Effect Value (EV) is  $6 \text{ (SR)} + 1 \text{ (Level)} + 2 \text{ (Influence)} = 9$ .

The Result: Her EV of 9 easily beats the Thug's Resistance of 3. The Thug loses 6 EP and is visibly startled. Since the action was successful, Sparks can pass Priority to an ally, but she has another action.

Action 2 (Move): "While he's distracted," Alex says, "I'll use my Traveler (Teleport) ability. I'm going to use my Move action to teleport behind the merchant to get between him and the Thug." She instantly relocates, ending her turn passing priority to the only remaining option, the Thug.

The Thug elects to flee, a victory for our team!



## Layer 3: Tactical Modifier

This layer adds temporary states and effects that modify the core gameplay.

### 1.0: Conditions

Your character can be affected by Conditions, Status Tags, and Boost Tags. These represent temporary states that can alter your capabilities or force you to make difficult choices.

(1.1) Conditions are persistent effects that are based on the character's states instead of Tags.

1. Mounted: another actor is riding you. While being ridden you are silenced unless commanded, you and the rider share initiative and action economy but the rider dictates all actions.
2. Riding: While Riding, you share initiative and action economy with your mount. You must use a Command action for your mount to perform an Effect Action using its keywords.
3. Prone: Disadvantage on all actions. Standing costs a Move Action.
4. Crouching: Grants advantage to concealment. Movement is halved.
5. Cover: Attacks against you suffer disadvantage. Grants advantage to Hide.
6. High Ground: +10 ft elevation. Advantage on ranged effects.
7. Submerged: Underwater. Disadvantage on actions; movement halved; grants cover.
8. Hidden: Undetected. Grants advantage on next action vs unaware target. Cannot be targeted.
9. Exhausted: SP = 0. Disadvantage on all rolls.
10. Injured: Max HP, SP, and EP are reduced by 5 (minimum 1) until next Downtime.
11. Unconscious: HP = 0 or asleep. Cannot act. The next HP loss is fatal.
12. Silenced: EP = 0, cannot use innate keywords.
13. Exposed: Actions gain Advantage when targeting Exposed targets.

### 2.0: Tags

A tag is a representation of a positive or negative effect that is placed on a player that requires a trigger to resolve and remove.

(2.1) When an effect applies a Tag, it is added to the target's "Tag Pool."

(2.1.1) A character can have multiple instances of the same Tag in their pool, but can have maximum total number of 10 boost stacks and 10 status stacks and a maximum of 5 of any one stack.

(2.2) Tags have a specific trigger condition defined by the keyword that grants the Tag.

(2.2.1) When that condition is met, only one instance of that Tag from the pool is resolved and removed.

(2.3) The only other way to remove Tags is through specific actions or keyword effects.

(2.3.1) When using such an ability, the player chooses which specific Tag(s) to remove from their pool.

#### (2.4) Status Tags

Status Tags are debilitating effects that act as Forced Consequences. Their effects are mandatory when their trigger condition is met.

1. Mark (Null): The next attack roll made against you gains Advantage. After the attack resolves, one Mark Tag is removed from your pool.



2. Impair (Silver): the next time you use an action that would cost Stamina (SP), the cost is increased by 1. After the cost is paid, one Impair Tag is removed from your pool.
3. Slow (Yellow): On your next turn, you have 1 fewer action (to a minimum of 1). At the end of that turn, one Slow Tag is removed from your pool.
4. Daze (Green): Your next SR is reduced by the number of Daze Tags in your pool, when that roll is resolved, one Daze Tag is removed from your pool.
5. Curse (Black): The next time you roll, you gain Disadvantage. After the roll resolves, one Curse Tag is removed from your pool.
6. Bind (Orange): While you have a Bind Tag in your pool, you are Immobilized. You can spend 1 SP, and an action, to remove one Bind Tag from your pool.
7. Weaken (White): The next time you take damage, your Resistance is reduced by 1 for each Weaken Tag in your Tag Pool. After the damage resolves, one Weaken Tag is removed from your pool.
8. Blight (Red): The next time you take any action or reaction, you immediately suffer 1 unavoidable point of value loss. After the damage is dealt, one Blight Tag is removed from your pool.
9. Silence (Blue): The next time you take an action, you cannot apply any Innate keywords to it. After that action resolves, one 'Silence' Tag is removed from your pool.
10. Nullify (Purple): When applied, the target's passive keywords are rendered inactive for as long as they have a nullify tag in their pool. When a nullify tag is added to the pool, remove a boost tag from the pool. A Nullify tag is removed when you gain priority for the first time in a round.

### (2.5) Boost Tags

Boost Tags are beneficial effects that act as Tactical Opportunities. The player who has the Tag chooses when to expend it.

1. Liberate (Null): When an effect would make you Immobilized, you may expend this Tag to negate that effect.
2. Augment (Silver): When you Activate an ability, you may expend this Tag to add any keyword to that effect (its EP cost must still be paid).
3. Haste (Yellow): At any point during your turn, you may expend this Tag to gain additional action.
4. Ward (Green): When you would be targeted by an action, you may expend this Tag to ignore that action's effects.
5. Bless (Black): When you make a roll, you may expend this Tag before rolling to gain Advantage.
6. Charge (Orange): When you would spend Energy Points (EP) to apply keywords, you may expend this Tag to reduce the total EP cost by 1.
7. Cure (White): As a free action on your turn, you may expend this Tag to remove one Status Tag from your pool.
8. Regen (Red): When you make an action, you may expend this Tag to restore 1 point to a Value of your choice.
9. Enhance (Blue): When you make a roll, you may expend this Tag after the roll to add a bonus to the final result equal to the caster's Influence.
10. Obscure (Purple): As an action, you may expend this Tag to become Hidden. The Target Number to locate you is  $10 + \text{Level} + \text{Chosen Stat}$ .

## (2.6) Range

The game uses range bands to determine distances.

(2.6.1) Range Bands define targeting and movement distances:

|                |                |
|----------------|----------------|
| Touch / Melee: | 0–1 meter      |
| Close:         | 1–3 meters     |
| Near:          | 3–10 meters    |
| Far:           | 10–100 meters  |
| Distant:       | 100–300 meters |

(2.6.2) When creating a ranged effect (targeting beyond melee):

- If using a projectile (e.g., arrow), the EV does not include a stat.
- If using a thrown object (e.g., manifested axe), the EV does not include level.
- The Ranged keyword restores both the stat and the level to the EV calculation.

(2.6.3) Ranged gear that normally requires ammunition does not track ammo. The Material keyword allows such gear to consume ammunition or crafting material for additional effect, as described under Reload and Material

**SPARKS IN ACTION: TAGS AND TEAMWORK**

Sparks has now reached Level 2 (by learning two more keywords in Downtime: Enhance (8.4) and Obscure (9.4)) and has placed a stat point into Influence, raising it to 3.

She and Rook are facing a Level 2 Security Captain. The Captain has a powerful effect that can inflict the Blight Tag.

The Attack: The Captain attacks Sparks. The effect hits, and the GM says, "Sparks, you take 3 damage, and you gain a Blight (Red) Status Tag." This Tag goes into Sparks' Tag Pool.

The Consequence: The GM reminds Alex of the Blight Tag's rule: "The next time you take any action or reaction, you immediately suffer 1 unavoidable point of value loss."

Sparks' Turn: It's Sparks' turn. She needs to act, but knows it will hurt.

Action 1 (Activate + Blight Trigger): Alex decides it's worth the pain. "I need to help Rook! I'm going to Activate my Enhance ability to give him a Boost Tag." The moment she declares the action, the Blight Tag triggers.

Blight Resolves: "Okay," the GM says, "the Blight resolves. You take 1 point of unavoidable damage to your HP, and the Blight Tag is removed from your pool." Sparks' HP drops.

Enhance Resolves: Now her chosen action proceeds. She makes her roll for the Enhance effect. It's successful, and Rook gains an Enhance Boost Tag that he can use later to add a bonus to one of his rolls.

Action 2 (Condition): "Now I need to get out of sight," Alex says. "I'll use my second action to take the Hide action and try to get into Cover behind some crates."

The Roll: She makes an Effort Roll using her Stealthy talent's passive Advantage: SR + Level + Stat. Her result is a 14.

The Result: The GM notes, "Your Hide TN is 14. You are now in Cover and have the Hidden condition. Enemies will have to beat that TN to find you."

## Layer 4: The Strategic Game

This layer reveals the full game structure, the rules for resolving different types of situations.

### 1.0: Scene Clock & Situation Types

The outcome of an entire Scene is determined by the party's ability to deplete the Scene Clock, which represents completing their primary objective through a series of situations, travel, and rest periods.

(1.1) The Scene Clock: This clock tracks progress towards the players' goal. It starts with a value based on the Scene's complexity (typically 8-15 points). It is depleted by 1 when Situation Clocks are resolved, Travel occurs, or a Rest is taken.

(1.2) Scenes are resolved using the standard Situation system. However, a Race Situation introduces a hard time limit via the Threat Clock.

(1.2.1) Standard Situation (Combat, Exploration, Social)

- Mechanic: Threat is managed through narrative consequences.
- Success: The Situation Clock is reduced to 0.
- Failure Consequence: When a Situation is failed, the scene is not ended, the GM may introduce a Complication (e.g., more enemies arrive, the objective becomes harder, an ally is put in danger).
- Resolution: The Scene is a Success if the Scene Clock is depleted. It is a Failure if the players are defeated or retreat.

(1.2.2) Race Situation (Timed, High-Stakes)

- Mechanic: This special situation type introduces the Threat Clock, turning the scene into a direct race against time.
- Success: The Situation Clock is depleted to 0.
- Partial Success: The Scene ends prematurely, and the Scene Clock has fewer points remaining than the Threat Clock.
- Failure: The Threat Clock is depleted to 0, or the Scene ends with the Threat Clock having fewer or equal points remaining than the Scene Clock.

(1.3) The Threat Clock: This mechanic is only used during a Race situation. Its size is determined by a simple lookup table, providing a "threat budget" based on the scene's difficulty.

(1.3.1) When a Timed Situation begins, the GM determines its Difficulty Category based on its Level Modifier. They then consult the table below, cross-referencing the Situation Level with the Difficulty Category to find the Threat Clock's starting value. This value is set for the entire scene.

| Difficulty Category | Level Modifier | Description                              |
|---------------------|----------------|------------------------------------------|
| Hard                | L+1 or L+2     | A tight race with little room for error. |
| Normal              | L+0            | A standard challenge with a fair buffer. |
| Easy                | L-1 or L-2     | A forgiving situation with ample time.   |

(1.3.2) Threat Budget Table:

| Situation Level | Hard | Normal | Easy |
|-----------------|------|--------|------|
| 1-3             | 8    | 15     | 20   |
| 4-6             | 12   | 20     | 30   |
| 7-9             | 16   | 25     | 40   |

(1.3.3) Depleting the Clock (The Cost of Action & Time):

1. Action Cost: Whenever a player makes an Effort Roll against a Barrier or Puzzle, the Threat Clock is immediately depleted by 1 point
2. Time Cost: At the end of every Round during a combat or other time-sensitive conflict within the Race, the Threat Clock is depleted by 1 point.

### SPARKS IN ACTION: RACING THE CLOCK

Sparks and Rook are now Level 3. They are in a Race Situation. A bomb is set to go off in a power conduit.

GM Setup: "This is a Race Situation. The Scene Clock starts at 5. You need to get through two Barriers (an outer and inner door) and defeat a final 'Boss' Sentry Turret to reach the bomb. Your main objective is the Situation Clock, which starts at 3 (for the three challenges)."

The Threat: "Because this is a Race, I am also activating the Threat Clock. Based on the difficulty, it starts at 15. It will tick down every round and every time you make an Effort Roll. If it reaches 0 before the Situation Clock, you fail."

The Race Begins:

Barrier 1: Rook uses Effort Rolls to break down the first door. Each time he makes an Effort Roll, the GM announces, "Okay, the Threat Clock ticks down by 1." The door is tough, and it takes him a full round. The GM says, "End of the round. The Threat Clock ticks down by 1 again." The Threat Clock is now at 13.

Barrier 2: Sparks takes over on the second door, which is a complex electronic lock (a Puzzle). She uses her Technique stat for her Effort Rolls. She succeeds, depleting the second clock. The Situation Clock is now at 2. The Threat clock is now at 12.

The Boss: They face the Sentry Turret. It's a tough fight that lasts two rounds. The Situation Clock is now at 0, the Threat Clock is now at 10.

They successfully finish the situation with time to spare!



## Layer 5: Entities, Items, and Progression

The world is populated by various beings and objects, defined by their mechanical and narrative significance.

### 1.0: Characters

These are the primary entities, possessing a full stat grid, resource Clocks, and the potential for growth through keywords and leveling.

(1.1) All Player Characters (PCs) and major Non-Player Characters (NPCs) like villains or key allies are considered Characters and have a Stat Grid, and Keywords.

(1.2) The Stat Grid:

Your character is defined by nine core Stats arranged in a 3x3 grid:

- Body: Movement (M), Alacrity (A), Brawn (B)
- Mind: Wit (W), Expertise (E), Technique (T)
- Essence: Power (P), Influence (I), Force (F)

|         | Control  | Execution | Foundation |
|---------|----------|-----------|------------|
| Body    | Movement | Alacrity  | Brawn      |
| Mind    | Wit      | Expertise | Technique  |
| Essence | Power    | Influence | Force      |

(1.2.1) An Entity has a value of 1 for each stat at level 0

(1.2.2) An Character has a value of 2 for each stat at level 1

(1.2.3) An Animation gains 1 points per level starting at level 1 that can be allocated to any stat to a maximum score of 5.

(1.2.4) A Character gains points based on their level that can be allocated to any stat to a maximum score of 5.

- Level 2-5: 1 point per Level
- Level 6-9: 2 points per Level

#### (1.3) Stat Definitions

(1.3.1) Movement (M - Body Control): Determines range bands traveled in a Move action.

(1.3.2) Alacrity (A - Body Execution): Determines the number of actions a character can make per turn, tie breaker for initiative.

(1.3.3) Brawn (B - Body Foundation): Determines the Bonus SP given during initiative and the restoration of stamina from the Recharge Action. Your Brawn may also determine how many Status Tags you can physically shrug off with the Recover action.

(1.3.4) Wit (W - Mind Control): Governs the effectiveness of the Ready and Recover action. Also determines who gets first priority in combat.

(1.3.5) Expertise (E - Mind Execution): Sets the hard limit for the number of item keywords you can use in an action; determines your Gear Passive Slot limit (Expertise).

(1.3.6) Technique (T - Mind Foundation): Determines scaling for numerous Keyword Effects.



(1.3.7) Power (P - Essence Control): Reduces EP cost of using active Innate keywords. And governs the Recharge Action.

(1.3.8) Influence (I - Essence Execution): Determines the quantity of Boost Tags you apply, and is one of the stats you can choose to determine how many Status Tags you remove with the Recover action. Also determines maximum number of persistent animations.

(1.3.9) Force (F - Essence Foundation): Determines your Innate Passive Slot limit (Force).

#### (1.4) Core Values: HP, SP, and EP Clocks

All Entities, Characters and Animations, have three Core Values (Clocks): Health Points (HP), Stamina Points (SP), and Energy Points (EP).

(1.4.1) These values reflect the state of an actor's body, effort, and inner power.

(1.4.2) Each value has a maximum of 10 unless modified by abilities, keywords, conditions, or gear.

(1.4.3) These values do not scale with level and must be managed carefully during play.

(1.4.4) Health Points (HP) Represents an actor's physical durability and ability to still defend and react.

- At 0: The actor becomes unguarded, incapacitated, or otherwise removed from the scene. The next source of damage is fatal if chosen to be.
- Recovery:
  - During Situations: Effects may restore HP.
  - Between Situations: The character may use Rest to recover 1 HP.
  - During Downtime: HP is fully restored at no Karma cost.

(1.4.5) Stamina Points (SP) Represents physical exertion and endurance and is spent on maneuvers, reactions, and other physical actions.

- At 0: The actor becomes Exhausted and suffers disadvantage on all rolls.
- Recovery:
  - During Situations: Certain effects may restore SP.
  - The Recharge Focus Action restores EP equal to your Brawn stat.
  - At Initiative: At the start of a Situation, when initiative is rolled, each actor regains SP equal to their Brawn stat. This recovery can exceed their maximum, creating temporary SP.
  - During Downtime: SP is fully restored at no Karma cost.

(1.4.6) Energy Points (EP) Represents inner strength, magical power, or narrative potential and is spent on applying keywords to actions and effects.

- At 0: The actor becomes Silenced, unable to use innate keywords.
- Recovery:
  - During Situations: Certain effects may restore EP.
  - The Recharge Focus Action restores EP equal to your Wit stat.
  - Between Situations: The actor must Rest to recover EP equal to their Force stat.
  - During Downtime: EP is fully restored at no Karma cost.

(1.4.7) Resistance: A character's Resistance is the sum of their three highest stats.

- Resistance is used to reduce incoming Effect Values (EVs).
- Passive abilities and actions can modify a character's Resistance.

## 2.0: Character Progression:

A character's growth in the Resonance system is a multi-stage journey, beginning at Level 0 and advancing as they master new keywords and unlock their full potential.

**(2.1) The Level 0 Entity (The Seed):**

(2.1.1) A character begins play at Level 0.

(2.1.2) A character begins with one (1) Seed Keyword: This is a single, defining keyword that represents the character's origin, innate quirk, or latent potential.

(2.1.3) All of the character's stats have a base value of 1.

**(2.2) The Awakening (Becoming Level 1):**

(2.2.1) The transition from Level 0 to Level 1 is a significant narrative event decided and granted by the DM. (Usually the conclusion of the first Episode or Scene)

(2.2.2) The character immediately learns three new keywords, bringing their total known keywords to four.

(2.2.3) The character's Level officially becomes 1.

(2.2.4) All nine of the character's stats are raised to a new baseline value, and new minimum, of 2.

**(2.3) Leveling Up (Level 2 and Beyond):**

(2.3.1) After the Awakening, progression is measured by the total number of permanent keywords a character has learned.

(2.3.2) For every two new permanent keywords learned, the character's Level increases by one.

(2.3.3) Each time a character gains a level, they are rewarded with stat points to allocate to any of their nine stats.

(2.3.4) The number of stat points granted is based on the level achieved:

- Levels 2 through 5 (Heroic): The character gains one (1) stat point per level.
- Levels 6 through 9 (Superhuman): The character gains two (2) stat points per level.

**(2.4) Level Progression Table**

| Level | Total Keywords | Stat Points Gained   |
|-------|----------------|----------------------|
| 1     | 4              | (All stats set to 2) |
| 2     | 6              | +1                   |
| 3     | 8              | +2                   |
| 4     | 10             | +3                   |
| 5     | 12             | +4                   |
| 6     | 14             | +6                   |
| 7     | 16             | +8                   |
| 8     | 18             | +10                  |
| 9     | 20             | +12                  |

**(2.5) The Stress Roll: Mid-Situation Growth**

A character can achieve a breakthrough in the heat of battle through a Stress Roll . This is a special check piggybacked onto an EV roll.

(2.5.1) Before making an EV roll, the player declares they are attempting a Stress Roll and names the specific keyword they are trying to learn.

(2.5.2) The player makes their EV roll as normal.

(2.5.3) The action's effect is resolved first, without the benefit of the attempted keyword.  
 (2.5.4) The Standard Roll (SR) from the dice is compared to the character's total number of known keywords. If  $SR > \text{Total Keywords}$ , the check succeeds.

- On success the newly learned keyword is immediately applied to the just-resolved effect. The character permanently learns the keyword, which may cause them to level up on the spot.
- The consequence of a successful Stress Roll means the character has traded future potential for immediate power and cannot learn a new keyword through a Stress Roll until they have had a period of Downtime.

### 3.0: Keywords

Powerful modifiers that can be applied to a variety of actions to mechanically alter effects.

(3.1) Keywords are gained through 3 primary methods, awakening, stress rolls, and karma.

(3.2) Keywords possess an Active Effect, a Passive Effect, and a Gear Effect.

(3.2.1) The Active Effect of a keyword is applied to an action and costs 1 EP per application.

(3.2.2) The Passive Effect of a Keyword is a constant effect on the character.

(3.2.3) The Gear Effect of all keywords possessed by the item are constantly applied to the item passively.

(3.3) An Entity can only benefit from a limited number of ongoing passive effects at one time, managed through two types of slots

(3.3.1) Innate Passive Slots: These are for keywords on the entity.

- A character has a number of Innate Passive Slots equal to their Force stat.
- During Downtime, a player may choose to slot or unslot their keywords as passive.

(3.3.2) Gear Passive Slots: These are for keywords on equipped items.

- A character can benefit from a number of passive keywords from their equipped gear equal to their Expertise.
- A character may choose to slot or unslot a gear passive as an action.

(3.4) Universal Keyword Rules:

(3.4.1) If a Keyword says you can do something the rules say you cannot, you can when the Keyword is applied.

(3.4.2) All Keyword applications cost 1 EP per Keyword unless the total cost is reduced or paid by another source.

(3.4.3) A Single Keyword cannot be applied to an effect multiple times unless that Keyword requires a choice. Each choice is a separate instance of the Keyword.

(3.4.4) All Boost and Status Keywords grant a Tag that has specific triggers that define when they are removed and how they are resolved.

(3.4.5) All Flaw Keywords require a chosen Keyword to replace the flaw's active ability. This chosen keyword is the flaw's Compensation Keyword.

(3.4.6) When an Entity or Item receives a flaw they may also take an additional Keyword that does not count towards their progression.

(3.4.7) An Entity or Item is Limited to one Flaw Keyword.

(3.4.8) If a Keyword alters a mechanic by a numerical value, if it is not based on a Stat Value (1-5), then it is assumed to be  $\pm 1$  or a Multiplier.

### (3.5) Simple Awakening

(3.5.1) When a Character awakens if you want an easy way to pick the three Keywords you can choose the category 1-3 keyword of the same color as the character's Seed Keyword.

(3.5.2) If the package contains a Keyword the character already has as their Seed Keyword, select another Keyword of the same color to replace the duplicate.

### (3.6) Multicolor Awakening Packages

#### (3.6.1) The Infiltrator

- Excels at stealth, surprise attacks, and controlling enemy actions.
- Seed Keyword: Stealthy (9.2) - Purple
- Awakening Keywords:
  - Snap (2.6) - Yellow
  - Martial (1.2) - Silver
  - Trickster (9.3) - Purple

#### (3.6.2) The Commander

- Focuses on battlefield awareness, buffing allies, and debuffing enemy defenses.
- Seed Keyword: Leader (8.2) - Blue
- Awakening Keywords:
  - Alert (0.3) - Null
  - Deadeye (6.2) - White
  - Sentry (2.2) - Yellow

#### (3.6.3) The Controller

- Manipulates the battlefield with forced movement and powerful physical maneuvers.
- Seed Keyword: Brawler (3.2) - Green
- Awakening Keywords:
  - Impact (3.8) - Green
  - Acrobatic (2.1) - Yellow
  - Leverage (5.8) - Orange

#### (3.6.4) The Berserker

- A high-risk, high-reward melee fighter who thrives on being damaged and applying status effects.
- Seed Keyword: Survivor (4.1) - Black
- Awakening Keywords:
  - Reckless (2.9) - Yellow
  - Exploit (6.8) - White
  - Curse (4.5) - Black

#### (3.6.5) The Artificer

- Specializes in creating and modifying items on the fly, using the environment as a weapon.
- Seed Keyword: Crafty (5.3) - Orange
- Awakening Keywords:
  - Improviser (5.2) - Orange
  - Sticky (6.6) - White
  - Material (5.7) - Orange

#### (3.6.6) The Guardian

- A defensive powerhouse focused on mitigating damage, healing allies, and holding the frontline.
- Seed Keyword: Sturdy (3.1) - Green
- Awakening Keywords:
  - Defensive (3.7) - Green



- Ward (3.4) - Green
- Restore (6.7) - White
- (3.6.7) The Warper
  - A reality-bending entity that uses unconventional movement and abilities to bypass normal limitations.
  - Seed Keyword: Traveler (1.1) - Silver
  - Awakening Keywords:
    - Phasing (1.7) - Silver
    - Split (7.9) - Red
    - Edit (0.9) - Null
- (3.6.8) The Leech
  - A debuff-focused character who drains enemy resources to sustain themselves.
  - Seed Keyword: Siphon (4.8) - Black
  - Awakening Keywords:
    - Flux (4.7) - Black
    - Regen (7.4) - Red
    - Blight (7.5) - Red
- (3.6.9) The Specialist
  - A non-combat character focused on support, social manipulation, and skill-based challenges.
  - Seed Keyword: Specialist (0.2) - Null
  - Awakening Keywords:
    - Insightful (8.3) - Blue
    - Bless (4.4) - Black
    - Charismatic (8.1) - Blue

## 4.0: Animations

Animations are entities with simplified rules, often created or controlled by Characters, and are commonly summoned creatures, machines, or otherwise autonomous entities.

(4.1) An Animation starts at Level 0 with a single seed keyword and all stats set to 1, same as a Character.

(4.2) An Animation also starts with 3 Values (HP, SP, EP) with a maximum of 10, Same as a Character.

(4.2.1) An Animation is affected by actions, conditions, and tags in the same way as a Character.

(4.3) An Animation will not advance on its own, it maintains a level one below its master or controller.

(4.3.1) Animations used as NPCs or that otherwise have no master have their level set by the GM.

(4.3.2) An Animation can be designated as a Minion

(4.3.3) A Minion has a Max HP of 1 and is defeated if any EV exceeds its Resistance.

(4.4) For each level above 0, an Animation gains 1 keyword and 1 stat point.

(4.5) An Animation has a number of innate passive slots equal to their level to a maximum of 5.

(4.6) Animations may have a number of Gear Passives slotted equal to their Expertise.

(4.7) A character can maintain a single Animation, regardless of level, passively during an Episode.

(4.8) At the end of a situation, if the character has more animations than they are allowed passively, the character chooses which animations persist, up to their maximum allowed, the rest disappear.

#### Example Animation: Clockwork Sentry

A mass-produced automaton of brass and steel, the Clockwork Sentry patrols ancient ruins and forgotten laboratories. It moves with a jerky, inhuman gait, its single crystalline eye glowing with a faint blue light as it scans for intruders.

Level: 2

HP: 10 | SP: 10 | EP: 10

Resistance: 5

Stat increases : B | T

Keywords (3 total):

Sentry (2.2): [Seed Keyword] Allows it to quickly assess targets.

Ranged (7.7): [Level 1 Keyword] Its primary attack is a projectile, allowing it to engage from a distance.

Mark (0.5): [Level 2 Keyword] Its attacks can "paint" a target with a Mark Tag, making them easier to hit.

GM Note: As an Animation, all of its keywords are considered "passively slotted" and always active. For a simpler encounter, you could designate this as a Minion, which would change its Max HP to 1.

## 5.0: NPCs

An NPC is an Entity that is fully controlled by the GM

(5.1) The type of entity and NPC determines its characteristics.

(5.1.1) NPC Characters include fully built characters that portray allies, villains and companions on par with the growth and potential of the players.

(5.1.2) NPC Animations include minions, summons, or similar background characters that have little to no narrative or mechanical impact to the scene.

(5.2) Companions are a special type of NPC bonded to a player character.

(5.2.1) Companions are always 1 level lower than their bonded PC.

(5.2.2.) They act independently and are controlled by the GM, but must be passed priority by their bonded Character to act during a situation.

(5.2.3) Only one companion may be bonded per PC at a time unless stated otherwise.

(5.2.4) A companion can be bonded during Downtime for 1 Karma.

## 6.0: Gear

All entities can utilize items and gear to perform actions or gain passive effects.

(6.1) A character may carry any number of items that are narratively appropriate, but they are limited to a number of passive equipment keywords equal to their Expertise stat.

(6.2) The passive keyword granted by an item should be narratively appropriate to that item.

(6.3) Equipment is assigned a Level from 0 to 9, which determines keyword capacity and power scaling.

(6.4) An item can hold 1 keyword per level, up to a maximum of 5 keywords at Level 4.

(6.5) When using the item to create an effect, use the item's level in place of the character's level to calculate the Effect Value (EV). If the level of the item is higher than the character's, use the character's level instead.

(6.6) When using gear to create an effect, you may combine any of its embedded keywords.



- (6.6.1) Only those keywords can be used in the effect for no cost. Any innate keywords added to the item's effect cost 1 EP each.
- (6.6.2) The gear effect of each keyword applies to the item it is embedded in passively and does not consume the character's equipment passive slots.
- (6.7) An item has a single Durability clock of 2, each successful effect that targets an item reduces its clock by one.
- 2: Undamaged - the item operates as intended
  - 1: Broken - any roll utilizing the item has Disadvantage
  - 0: Destroyed - Item and any keywords it possesses cannot be accessed or utilized.
- (6.8) An item can only have its Durability clock restored by Crafting, or a Restore Keyword Action.

### Kinetic Gauntlet

A heavy, oversized gauntlet forged from interlocking bronze plates. It hums with a low, vibrant energy, and the air crackles when you clench your fist.

(Level 2 Item)

Keywords (2 total):

Impact (3.8): Effects from this gauntlet carry immense force, knocking targets around the battlefield.

Leverage (5.8): Maneuvers made with this gauntlet, like Shove or Restrain, gain Advantage.

Durability Clock: [ ][ ] (3 stages - 2: Undamaged, 1: Broken, 0: Destroyed)

Using This Item:

When you make an Activate action to strike an enemy with this gauntlet, you use the item's Level (2) in your EV calculation instead of your own. The keywords Impact and Leverage can be used as part of any effect made with the gauntlet at no EP cost. For example, if you use a Shove maneuver, the Leverage keyword would grant you Advantage on the roll, and the Impact keyword would allow you to knock the target into another enemy.

## 7.0: Crafting

Characters can engage in crafting to create new items or effects, or to modify existing permanent effects on a target.

(7.1) During Downtime, a character can craft an item or effect of their Level or lower.

(7.2) During a Rest, a character can craft an item or effect with a level equal to their Expertise stat.

(7.3) Crafting during a rest consumes the character's Rest and prevents them from restoring any HP, SP, or EP during that rest.

(7.4) Crafting reduces the character's maximum SP by 1 until it is restored during Downtime.

(7.5) Crafted items or effects may only include Keywords available to the character (from their own list, allies, or other gear within the same location).

(7.6) Crafting can be used to restore a Broken or Destroyed item or effect, of equal level to the player or lower, to Undamaged.

## 8.0: Factions

Factions represent groups organized by shared identity, whether through location, ideology, or survival.

- (8.1) Characters interact with factions across scenes and downtime, influencing them through story choices and Karma investments.
- (8.2) During Downtime, a character can spend Karma to grant a civil system to a faction.
- (8.3) A Faction's level is determined by the number of Civil Systems they have Established.
- (8.4) Civil Systems and Faction Growth:
- (8.4.1) Food - Aid Unlocked: Info, Rumors, secrets, maps, and intelligence.
  - (8.4.2) Water - Aid Unlocked: Access, Passes, safehouses, and travel routes.
  - (8.4.3) Shelter - Aid Unlocked: Downtime, Free rest, conversion, recovery.
  - (8.4.4) Infrastructure - Aid Unlocked: Equipment, Tools, upgrades, and unique gear.
  - (8.4.5) Humanitarian - Aid Unlocked: Protection, Guards, rescues, or sheltering.
  - (8.4.6) Education - Aid Unlocked: Training, Boosts, upgrades, techniques.
  - (8.4.7) Healthcare - Aid Unlocked: Companions, Allies, or NPCs.
  - (8.4.8) Government - Aid Unlocked: Influence, Change laws, secure leverage.
  - (8.4.9) Commerce - Aid Unlocked: Trade Goods, Surpluses and rare access.
  - (8.4.10) Military - Aid Unlocked: Property, Bases, fortresses, and command.
- (8.5) Characters earn or lose Faction Trust through story actions, success or failure of a situation, or defeat of faction members.

### Example Faction: The Rivertown Coalition

A hardy group of survivors who have built a fortified settlement on the banks of a wide, defensible river. They are pragmatic and self-sufficient, valuing tangible contributions and deeds over words. While wary of strangers, they are willing to trade and cooperate with those who prove themselves trustworthy.

The Rivertown Coalition (Level 3 Faction)

Current Goal: To secure their territory and establish trade routes with other nearby settlements.

Faction Trust:

- Ally: You are considered one of their own. They will offer you shelter and aid freely and come to you with their problems.
- Neutral: They are cautious but willing to trade. Access to their inner settlement and leaders is restricted.
- Enemy: You are seen as a threat. They will be hostile on sight and may actively work against you.

Established Civil Systems (3/10):

Food: They have established reliable farming and fishing.

Aid Unlocked: They can provide valuable Information about the local area (maps, rumors, monster weaknesses).

Shelter: Their longhouse provides a safe place for the community to rest.

Aid Unlocked: If the players are trusted, they can use the Downtime activity here for free, fully recovering.

Infrastructure: They have built a defensive wall and a basic workshop.

Aid Unlocked: They can provide access to basic Tools and Equipment for crafting or repairs.

Interacting with the Coalition:

The players' Faction Trust with the Coalition will rise and fall based on their actions. Completing a task for them, like clearing out a nearby monster den, would increase their Trust. Stealing from them or betraying their trust would lower it.

**Growing the Faction:**

During a Downtime phase, a player who is trusted by the Coalition can choose to help them grow.

Example: Alex's character, Sparks, is an Ally of the Coalition. She decides to spend 1 Karma using the Inspire downtime action to help them organize a proper infirmary. This establishes the Healthcare Civil System.

The Result: The Rivertown Coalition is now a Level 4 Faction. The next time the players visit, the Coalition will have a new type of Aid unlocked: they can now introduce the players to potential Companions or Allies (like a retired guard or a skilled herbalist) who might be willing to join them on their adventures.

## 9.0: The Karma System

Karma is a special resource representing narrative influence, earned through dramatic roleplay and as a reward for resolving a situation

(9.1) Karma can be spent at any time to reroll the result of an action or effort roll. The new roll replaced the previous.

(9.3) Karma can also be spent during a situation or downtime to gain specific benefits:

(9.3.1) Rest (1 Karma)

- Situation: Add 1 point to your current HP
- Downtime: Restore all Values to Max (No Karma Cost)

(9.3.2) Restore (1 Karma)

- Situation: Remove a Number of Status Tags from Your pool equal to your Brawn, Wit, or Influence
- Downtime: Remove the Injured Condition

(9.3.3) Recharge (1 Karma)

- Situation: Add your Wit to your current EP
- Downtime: Upgrade one gear item to be at an equal level with your character

(9.3.4) Learn (1 Karma)

- Situation: Grant your next roll Advantage
- Downtime: Begin your next situation with Surprise

(9.3.5) Grow (Level/2 Karma, rounded Up)

- Situation: Add any Keyword to an Activate action (1 Karma)
- Downtime: Add a new Innate Keyword to your Character, limited to once per Downtime

(9.3.6) Create (1 Karma)

- Situation: Manifest an item equal to your Characters level until the end of the situation
- Downtime: Grant a Faction a keyword to utilize for Gear and Entities

(9.3.7) Inspire (1 Karma)

- Situation: Grant a target or yourself a number of any one Boost Tag equal to your Wit
- Downtime: Grant a Faction a new Civil System and increase its Level

(9.3.8) Mentor (1 Karma)

- Situation: Allow an Animation or Companion under your control the ability to use keywords without a command action on their next turn.
- Downtime: Bond with an Animation or Companion limited to one level below your character's level

(9.3.9) Amplify (1 Karma)

- Situation: Your next roll is considered critical.

- Downtime: Create a permanent Environmental Effect or Trap equal to your level

**SPARKS IN ACTION: THE STRESS ROLL**

Sparks is now Level 4 with 10 total keywords. She has allocated her stat points into Influence (3), Wit (3), and Force (3). She and Rook are in a desperate fight. Rook is badly injured, and Sparks needs a way to heal him. She doesn't know any healing keywords.

Alex's Declaration: "This is it. I need to save him. I'm going to attempt a Stress Roll to learn the Restore (6.7) keyword!"

The GM: "Bold move. First, declare the action you're taking."

Alex: "I'm using the Activate action. I'm putting my hand on Rook's chest and trying to channel my energy to heal him."

The Roll and Resolution:

The Action: Alex makes her EV roll. She rolls an SR of 14 (Double 5's and a 4). The effect resolves without the Restore keyword, so it does nothing.

The Stress Check: The GM asks, "Okay, what was your SR?" "14," Alex replies. "And how many keywords do you currently know?" "10."

The Result: The GM announces, "Your SR of 14 is greater than your total keywords of 10. The Stress Roll succeeds! A wave of white energy flows from your hands. The Restore keyword is immediately applied to the action you just took."

The Aftermath: Alex calculates the Restore effect (Level + Technique), healing Rook. Sparks has now permanently learned Restore, bringing her total keywords to 11. She will level up to Level 5 during the next Downtime if she spends Karma for another Keyword.

Item Interaction:

Later, the party finds a Level 2 Med-Kit. The GM says it has two keywords: Cure (6.4) and Regen (7.4).

Alex: "Awesome. My Expertise stat is 2, so I have enough Gear Passive slots to benefit from both of these passives while I have the kit equipped!"

This demonstrates how a character can grow mid-combat and how they interact with the gear they find.



## Layer 6: Layer Mastery and Modularity

(1.0) The layers are not just a learning ramp, they are also a modular system to be applied or ignored at any level of play.

(1.1) Any scene may discard or utilize any aspect of the layer system to increase speed of play or mechanical simplicity when the full system would otherwise break the immersion and pacing of play.

(1.2) The Game Master has the role and responsibility to be the curator of play to decide when these points of lax or strict rule application may be applied to ensure a fun and fair play environment.

### SPARKS IN ACTION: GM AS CURATOR

Sparks and Rook are chasing a target through a crowded marketplace. This could be a complex Scene with lots of mechanics, but the GM decides that tracking every roll would slow down the pace and ruin the tension of the chase.

The GM declares, "Okay everyone, for this Scene, we're going to use the Modularity rule. We're setting aside the detailed action catalog. This will be a pure narrative chase."

Instead of turn-by-turn actions, the GM presents a series of narrative choices:

- "The target ducks into a packed alleyway. Sparks, do you use your Traveler (Teleport) to try and get ahead of him, or do you use your Insightful ability to try and predict where he'll emerge?"
- "Rook, the crowd is panicking. Do you use your Brawn to shove your way through, possibly causing a scene, or do you use a Teamwork action to help clear a path for Sparks?"

In this example, the GM, acting as the Curator of Play, has chosen to discard specific layers of the rules (like the strict action economy) to better serve the story's pacing and excitement. This shows how the system is designed to be a flexible toolkit, not a rigid prison.

## Appendix A: Master Keyword List

### Keywords

A Keyword is the fundamental building block of an Entity's or an Item's abilities. When an Entity makes an action that permits a keyword to be applied they may do so when declaring the action to alter its effect.

| color     | 0. flaw    | 1. gift     | 2. talent  | 3. quirk   | 4. boost | 5. status | 6. form  | 7. modifier | 8. drive | 9. Unique   |
|-----------|------------|-------------|------------|------------|----------|-----------|----------|-------------|----------|-------------|
| 0.null    | Restricted | aura        | specialist | alert      | Liberate | Mark      | indirect | adaptive    | gamble   | edit        |
| 1. silver | Bane       | Traveler    | martial    | attuned    | Augment  | Impair    | reactive | phasing     | brutal   | translocate |
| 2. yellow | Anxious    | acrobatic   | sentry     | eidetic    | Haste    | slow      | snap     | condense    | rapid    | reckless    |
| 3. green  | Hesitant   | sturdy      | brawler    | stubborn   | ward     | daze      | sculpt   | defensive   | impact   | shift       |
| 4. black  | Feeble     | survivor    | stoic      | ageless    | Bless    | Curse     | piercing | flux        | siphon   | animate     |
| 5. orange | Gremlins   | sensor      | Improviser | crafty     | Charge   | Bind      | imbue    | material    | leverage | manifest    |
| 6. white  | Vulnerable | tolerant    | deadeye    | immunized  | Cure     | weaken    | sticky   | restore     | Exploit  | growth      |
| 7. red    | Limited    | resilient   | font       | insulated  | Regen    | blight    | area     | range       | multiply | split       |
| 8. blue   | Awkward    | charismatic | leader     | insightful | Enhance  | silence   | splash   | lingering   | spread   | potent      |
| 9. purple | Mundane    | aware       | stealthy   | trickster  | Obscure  | nullify   | chain    | natural     | ambiance | channel     |

## Color 0: Null (Unpredictability & Potential)

### 0.0 Restricted (Flaw)

Intent: A fundamental limitation or flaw that inhibits the use of one's full power.

Passive: Each keyword you use costs double the Energy (EP) to activate.

Active: When you take this Flaw, choose a Compensation Keyword. You may use the Active effect of that keyword as if you knew it.

Equipment: All costs to activate this item's keywords are doubled.

### 0.1 Aura (Gift)

Intent: The outward manifestation of one's inner power as a tangible field of energy.

Passive: You are surrounded by a tangible field of energy that you can manipulate with thought to physically interact with the world.

Active: Grants a +1 to the EV of any roll with a keyword that matches your aura color.

Equipment: The item can manifest simple, non-mechanical objects made of light or pure force.

### 0.2 Specialist (Talent)

Intent: A deep, focused mastery over a particular domain of one's own capabilities.

Passive: Choose one Stat Grid category (Body, Mind, or Essence). You have Advantage on all non-combat Effort Rolls that use a stat from your chosen category.

Active: Once per Situation, you may gain Advantage on a reaction or action that uses a stat of your chosen category.

Equipment: The wielder gains Advantage on Effort Rolls made using this item.

### 0.3 Alert (Quirk)

Intent: An uncanny and preternatural awareness of one's immediate surroundings.

Passive: You cannot be surprised unless you are incapacitated.

Active: Gain Advantage on effects targeting concealed targets.

Equipment: The item passively indicates to the wielder any activity parameters set at its creation.

### 0.4 Liberate (Boost)

Intent: The power to grant or achieve absolute freedom from physical or magical restraint.

Passive: At the start of combat, gain a number of Liberate Tags equal to your Influence.

Active: When this keyword is part of an effect, grant the target the Liberate Tag and add stacks to their Total Boosts pool equal to your Influence.

Equipment: As an action, the wielder can use this item to remove a restraint or lock.

Trigger Effect: You may spend one Liberate Tag from your pool to ignore a movement-reducing or bind effect targeting you.

### 0.5 Mark (Status)

Intent: The act of designating a target, exposing a fundamental weakness for all to see.

Passive Trigger: The next incoming effect treats you as exposed. After the effect is resolved, remove a Mark Tag.

Active: When this keyword is part of a successful effect, grant the target the Mark Tag.

Equipment: On a successful hit, this item grants the target the Mark Tag and adds stacks to their Total Statuses pool equal to the wielder's Influence.

## 0.6 Indirect (Form)

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Intent: An effect that can bypass obstacles, striking from an unexpected angle or origin.

Passive: You maintain awareness of targets regardless of cover.

Active: This effect can strike a target and ignore cover.

Equipment: Attacks made with this item ignore the defensive benefits of Cover.

## 0.7 Adaptive (Modifier)

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Intent: The ability for an effect to change its nature to target a different aspect of a foe's resilience.

Passive: You can choose which value (HP, SP, or EP) your effects will target.

Active: You can choose which value (HP, SP, or EP) this specific effect will damage.

Equipment: Choose a value when this keyword is added to an item. Effects made with this item always target the chosen value.

## 0.8 Gamble (Drive)

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Intent: A reliance on pure chance, surrendering control for unpredictable, potentially powerful outcomes.

Passive: You may choose to replace any single level or stat value in a roll with a d10 roll. If improvising equipment to apply a Status, the die result (0-9) determines the Status Tag applied.

Active: You may replace all level and stat values in this roll with separate d10 rolls.

Equipment: You may replace the item's Level in an EV calculation with a d10 roll.

## 0.9 Edit (Unique)

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Intent: The power to fundamentally rewrite the properties of oneself, another, or an object.

Passive: As an action, you may change one of your known keywords to another keyword of the same Category.

Active: On a successful hit, you may change one of the target's keywords until their next Downtime.

Equipment: The wielder may use an action to change any keyword on this item to another keyword they personally know.

## Color 1: Silver (Duality & Adaptation)

### 1.0 Bane (Flaw)

**Intent:** A specific, acute vulnerability to a certain type of power or substance.

**Passive:** Choose a Color when you take this Flaw. If an effect contains a keyword of that color, it ignores your resistances.

**Active:** When you take this Flaw, choose a Compensation Keyword. You may use the Active effect of that keyword as if you knew it.

**Equipment:** This item is immediately destroyed if successfully affected by an effect containing a keyword of your chosen Bane Color.

### 1.1 Traveler (Gift)

**Intent:** An innate affinity for a specific, unconventional mode of movement.

**Passive:** Choose a Color. You permanently gain the associated movement type.

**Active:** As part of this effect, you may immediately move according to a chosen movement type.

**Equipment:** The wielder gains access to the chosen movement type while this item is equipped.

0. Null - Walk: Default; follows terrain and cover rules.
1. Silver - Teleport: Instantly relocate to a visible or attuned location.
2. Yellow - Fly: Move freely in all directions.
3. Green - Dig: Move through loose solids.
4. Black - Permeation: Pass through solid matter.
5. Orange - Jump: Leap directly to a visible location.
6. White - Parkour: Ignore penalties from difficult terrain.
7. Red - Climb: Traverse vertical surfaces effortlessly.
8. Blue - Swim: Move through liquids.
9. Purple - Lightfoot: Walk on non-gas surfaces; tremorsense can't detect.

### 1.2 Martial (Talent)

**Intent:** Proficiency in close-quarters combat and the ability to react instantly to threats.

**Passive:** You can make a basic EV attack against a target that moves into your touch range. This reaction cannot use keywords.

**Active:** Gain Advantage on a reaction.

**Equipment:** Gain Advantage when using this item as part of a reaction.

### 1.3 Attuned (Quirk)

**Intent:** A deep, persistent sympathetic link to a person, place, or thing.

**Passive:** During Downtime, you can link yourself to a willing or non-living target. You always know the target's location and status.

**Active:** This effect can target your attuned target regardless of range, distance, or cover.

**Equipment:** Items linked together via the Attuned passive can target each other with their effects when utilized.

### 1.4 Augment (Boost)

**Intent:** The power to temporarily grant additional abilities or options to an ally or oneself.



Passive: At the start of combat, gain a number of Augment Tags equal to your Influence.

Active: When this keyword is part of an effect, grant the target a number of Augment Tags equal to your Influence

Equipment: The object can be used to grant access to a single keyword to its wielder (chosen at crafting).

Trigger Effect: You may spend one Augment Tag from your tag pool to add any single keyword to an effect (the keyword's EP cost must still be paid).

## 1.5 Impair (Status)

Intent: A curse that drains a target's stamina, making every action more difficult.

Passive Trigger: If you would make an action or reaction that would cost SP increase that cost by one then remove an Impair Tag

Active: When this keyword is part of a successful effect, grant the target the Impair Tag.

Equipment: On a successful hit, this item grants the target the Impair Tag.

## 1.6 Reactive (Form)

Intent: The ability to seamlessly weave potent abilities into defensive maneuvers.

Passive: you may add keywords to dodge reactions up to your TEC, you must still pay all EP costs.

Active: Whenever you apply this keyword to a Dodge reaction, you may add a Chosen Stat to the SR an additional time.

Equipment: When used in a Dodge reaction, the reaction has no SP cost.

## 1.7 Phasing (Modifier)

Intent: An effect that becomes intangible, passing through physical defenses to strike a target's essence.

Passive: Your effects can be designated to ignore objects, specified targets, and physical cover.

Active: Effects with this keyword ignore all resistances from gear and cover.

Equipment: This gear ignores physical barriers, cover, and gear; it only affects the target's Energy.

## 1.8 Brutal (Drive)

Intent: A fighting style focused on overwhelming, devastatingly powerful critical blows.

Passive: Critical effects from this character are multiplied by 3 instead of 2.

Active: Effects with this keyword are a critical hit on a SR result of 6+.

Equipment: Effects from this gear are a critical hit on a SR result of 6+.

## 1.9 Translocate (Unique)

Intent: The mastery of teleportation and the manipulation of spatial boundaries.

Passive: You have a personal pocket dimension to store and recall targets.

Active: As part of this effect, you may instantly change a target's position to another target location.

Equipment: This object contains a portal to a set location, a storage pocket dimension, or can be re-equipped as part of any action regardless of its location.

## Color 2: Yellow (Immediacy & Motion)

### 2.0 Anxious (Flaw)

Intent: A nervous disposition that makes it difficult to focus or aim with precision.

Passive: Your Focus actions cost double.

Active: When you take this Flaw, choose a Compensation Keyword. You may use the Active effect of that keyword as if you knew it.

Equipment: Effects from this gear cannot be used to make a called shot.

### 2.1 Acrobatic (Gift)

Intent: The ability to move with extraordinary grace, blending movement and action into one.

Passive: You may ignore any hindering environmental effects that would affect movement or positioning.

Active: You can apply this keyword to any action to make a Move action as part of the effect.

Equipment: The wielder may make a Move action as part of an action that utilizes this gear.

### 2.2 Sentry (Talent)

Intent: A keen eye for detail and the ability to rapidly assess a target's nature.

Passive: You can make one free assessment when encountering a target for the first time.

Active: You may perform an Assess action as a single action instead of a full turn action.

Equipment: Choose one clue type at creation. When this gear affects a target, the wielder learns that specific clue.

### 2.3 Eidetic (Quirk)

Intent: A perfect, flawless memory of all sensory experiences.

Passive: You can remember all details you have experienced, including visual, audio, and any other sense.

Active: This effect gains Advantage against any target type you have encountered before.

Equipment: This item can store sensory information.

### 2.4 Haste (Boost)

Intent: A surge of supernatural speed, granting additional actions in a flurry of motion.

Passive: At the start of combat, gain the Haste Tag and add stacks to your Total Boosts pool equal to your Influence.

Active: When this keyword is part of an effect, grant the target a number of Haste Tags equal to your Influence.

Equipment: You may make an additional action your turn utilizing this item.

Trigger Effect: You may spend one Haste Tag from your tag pool to immediately gain one additional action this turn.

### 2.5 Slow (Status)

Intent: A temporal effect that traps a target, reducing their ability to act.

Passive Trigger: At the beginning of your turn, reduce your total actions by 1 for that turn and remove one Slow Tag from your Tag pool.

**Active:** When this keyword is part of a successful effect, grant the target the Slow Tag and add stacks to their Total Statuses pool equal to your Influence.

**Equipment:** On a successful hit, this item grants the target the Slow Tag.

## 2.6 Snap (Form)

---

**Intent:** An effect so fast it is impossible to react to.

**Passive:** You can make reactions to any effect, including those with Snap.

**Active:** This effect cannot be responded to. It is limited to a single strike or trigger, regardless of other keywords.

**Equipment:** This equipment can be used to react to any effect.

## 2.7 Condense (Modifier)

---

**Intent:** The principle of applying greater force by concentrated effort or material.

**Passive:** You may focus or condense materials energy or forces into a focal point.

**Active:** You may apply another stat of your choice to the EV calculation, this can duplicate the initial chosen stat.

**Equipment:** If the wielder uses only this item for the effect, they may apply another stat of their choice to the EV calculation of its effects.

## 2.8 Rapid (Drive)

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**Intent:** A flurry of multiple, successive strikes or triggers.

**Passive:** You can spend 1 SP to replicate any form of travel during a move action.

**Active:** This effect strikes or triggers a number of additional times equal to your Technique (TEC). You do not add your Level to the EV of these hits; instead, you apply the chosen stat a second time to the EV calculation.

**Equipment:** When used, this item's effect strikes or triggers a number of additional times equal to the wielder's Expertise (EXP). These extra hits do not add the item's Level to the EV; instead, the wielder may apply their Expertise a second time to the EV calculation.

## 2.9 Reckless (Unique)

---

**Intent:** A dangerous state of abandoning all defense for pure, unadulterated offense.

**Passive:** As part of an action, you can toggle a reckless state. While in this state, you are Exposed, and all of your own effects gain Advantage.

**Active:** If you are currently Locked On to the target, you may add your Level to the effect's EV an additional time.

**Equipment:** If the wielder is Locked On to a target, they may add the item's Level to the effect's EV an additional time..

## Color 3: Green (Stability & Resilience)

### 3.0 Hesitant (Flaw)

Intent: A chronic inability to react quickly, leaving one vulnerable.

Passive: You have Disadvantage on all React Actions you take.

Active: When you take this Flaw, choose a Compensation Keyword. You may use the Active effect of that keyword as if you knew it.

Equipment: Utilizing this gear takes a full turn instead of a single action.

### 3.1 Sturdy (Gift)

Intent: An unshakable physical presence, impossible to move or knock down.

Passive: Maneuvers that target you gain Disadvantage. You also cannot be forced to move or made prone.

Active: Add your Level to reactions against maneuvers.

Equipment: The wielder adds this gear's Level to their reactions made against Maneuver actions.

### 3.2 Brawler (Talent)

Intent: Expertise in grappling and other physical maneuvers in combat.

Passive: You can make Maneuver actions without costing Stamina (SP).

Active: You may apply this keyword to a Maneuver action to allow you to add other keywords you know to it, up to a number equal to your Technique (TEC).

Equipment: Utilizing this gear to perform a Maneuver action removes the action's SP cost.

### 3.3 Stubborn (Quirk)

Intent: A sheer refusal to accept failure, allowing one to try again.

Passive: You can spend 1 SP to reroll any Effort Roll you make.

Active: If this effect is successfully reacted to by the target, you may spend 1 SP to immediately reroll your EV to change the outcome.

Equipment: The wielder can spend 1 SP to reroll an Effort Roll when utilizing this gear.

### 3.4 Ward (Boost)

Intent: A protective blessing that can completely negate a single incoming threat.

Passive: At the start of combat, add a number of Ward Tags to your Tag pool equal to your Influence.

Active: When this keyword is part of an effect, grant the target a number of Ward Tags to your Tag pool equal to your Influence..

Equipment: This item can be used to replace its wielder as the target for an effect as a reaction.

Trigger Effect: You may spend one Ward Tag from your tag pool to cause a single incoming effect targeting you to be ignored.

### 3.5 Daze (Status)

Intent: A disorienting blow to the mind or senses that leaves a target unable to act coherently.

Passive Trigger: when you would roll for EV reduce the. Result by the number of Daze Tags in your tag pool, then remove one Daze Tag from your tag pool.



Active: When this keyword is part of a successful effect, grant the target the Daze Tag.

Equipment: On a successful hit, this item grants the target the Daze Tag..

### 3.6 Sculpt (Form)

---

Intent: The power to alter the superficial shape or form of an object or target.

Passive: As an action, you can change the cosmetic appearance or superficial form of an object or target (without changing its raw materials).

Active: This effect occupies a space that fits within 5 connected 1-meter cubes × your Technique (TEC).

Equipment: This equipment can be used to change the shape or form of a target.

### 3.7 Defensive (Modifier)

---

Intent: The philosophy of outlasting an opponent through superior fortitude and resilience.

Passive: You may add a number of keywords to a Block reaction up to your Technique Stat and all EP costs must still be paid

Active: You add your Level to your resistance.

Equipment: When used in a block reaction, that reaction has no SP cost.

### 3.8 Impact (Drive)

---

Intent: An effect that carries immense kinetic force, knocking targets around the battlefield.

Passive: You ignore secondary damage from striking or being struck by Impact effects.

Active: This effect forces the target to move or be knocked down. If the forced movement causes the target to strike another object, your EV is rolled a second time and affects both.

Equipment: Effects from this item can force a target to move or be knocked down.

### 3.9 Shift (Unique)

---

Intent: The ability to fundamentally alter one's own physical form and attributes.

Passive: As part of an action, you can relocate a number of stat points equal to your Technique (TEC). You can also change your form/appearance.

Active: This effect will change the target's appearance and form.

Equipment: This item can change its appearance and form as part of an effect.



## Color 4: Black (Inevitability & Endurance)

### 4.0 Feeble (Flaw)

Intent: A chronic physical weakness that hinders bodily action.

Passive: You have Disadvantage on any roll that uses a Body stat.

Active: When you take this Flaw, choose a Compensation Keyword. You may use the Active effect of that keyword as if you knew it.

Equipment: The wielder has Disadvantage when applying a Body stat to effects made with this gear.

### 4.1 Survivor (Gift)

Intent: An incredible tenacity for life, allowing one to cling to existence beyond normal limits.

Passive: All of your values must be zero for you to be downed.

Active: As a reaction that costs 1 SP, if an effect would reduce your HP to 0, you may use this keyword to instead be reduced to 1 HP.

Equipment: As long as this item is not broken, the wielder cannot be downed unless their Stamina is zero.

### 4.2 Stoic (Talent)

Intent: An unshakable mental focus and economy of action.

Passive: You may make a focus action as a single action instead of taking a full turn.

Active: When this keyword is applied to an effect the EV roll can not have Disadvantage or Advantage applied.

Equipment: This gear may be used to perform a designated Focus action as a single action.

### 4.3 Ageless (Quirk)

Intent: The state of being outside the normal flow of time and aging.

Passive: Once you reach maturity, you no longer age and can no longer die of natural causes.

Active: Effects with this keyword are immune to the Growth keyword.

Equipment: This item is immune to the Growth keyword.

### 4.4 Bless (Boost)

Intent: A boon of fortune that enhances positive outcomes and aids restoration.

Passive: At the start of combat, gain a number of Bless Tags to your Tag pool equal to your Influence.

Active: When this keyword is part of an effect, grant the target a number of Bless Tags to your Tag pool equal to your Influence.

Equipment: Choose a value. When the wielder has that value restored, increase the amount by 1.

Trigger Effect: You may spend one Bless Tag from your Tag pool when a value is restored to increase the amount by 1, or to gain Advantage on a roll.

### 4.5 Curse (Status)

Intent: A withering hex that invites misfortune and foils attempts to recover.

**Passive Trigger:** When you make a roll, gain disadvantage on that roll and remove a Curse Tag

**Active:** When this keyword is part of a successful effect, grant the target the Curse Tag.

**Equipment:** On a successful hit, this item grants the target the Curse Tag.

## 4.6 Piercing (Form)

**Intent:** An unstoppable, penetrating force that ignores all defenses but deals minimal harm.

**Passive:** You can set the origin point of an effect to anywhere within your current range.

**Active:** This effect hits everything in its path and continues to maximum range, ignoring cover and resistance and bypassing Ward.

**Equipment:** This item or its parts can pass through anything. Its EV is fixed at 1 and it bypasses resistance, cover, and Ward.

## 4.7 Flux (Modifier)

**Intent:** The ability to convert one's own vitality or energy into raw power.

**Passive:** As an action, you can spend any of your values to grant them to another target as a separate resource pool. This pool disappears at the end of the target's turn.

**Active:** You may choose to spend a value to increase this effect's EV by the amount spent up to a maximum of your Technique.

**Equipment:** This item can be used to store and dispense values as part of an effect (storage maximum equal to items level).

## 4.8 Siphon (Drive)

**Intent:** The principle of forcibly transferring essence or life force from one being to another.

**Passive:** As an action, you can siphon values from willing targets. Values gained this way cannot exceed your maximum.

**Active:** When this ability deals value loss to a target, you restore 1 point to one of your own Values.

**Equipment:** This object stores values targeted by its effect, up to a maximum capacity equal to the equipment's Level. The wielder can expend these stored points as if they were their own.

## 4.9 Animate (Unique)

**Intent:** The power of necromancy or artifice, granting temporary life to the inanimate.

**Passive:** You can passively maintain a number of animations whose combined levels are equal to your own level.

**Active:** As part of an effect, you can animate a non-living target, turning it into a temporary Animation under your control. The new Animation's level cannot exceed your own level minus the combined levels of any other Animations you already control.

**Equipment:** This item has a specific animation bonded to it, which can be manifested and controlled. This bonded animation does not count toward your character's normal limit.

## Color 5: Orange (Creation & Chaos)

### 5.0 Gremlins (Flaw)

Intent: A persistent streak of bad luck, causing critical failures at the worst moments.

Passive: A die result of 1 on any roll is a miss or failed effect.

Active: When you take this Flaw, choose a Compensation Keyword. You may use the Active effect of that keyword as if you knew it.

Equipment: A die result of 1 when using this gear will break it and cause the effect to miss or fail.

### 5.1 Sensor (Gift)

Intent: The possession of a supernatural or technological sense beyond the mundane.

Passive: Choose a Color. You permanently gain the associated sense at a range set by your Wit (WIT) stat.

Active: Utilize a sense of your choice at full range in a radius around the target.

Equipment: The wielder gains access to the chosen sense type while this item is equipped.

1. Null - Karma
2. Silver - Keywords
3. Yellow - Echolocation
4. Green - Vibration
5. Black - Energy
6. Orange - Materials
7. White - Life
8. Red - Infrared
9. Blue - Emotion
10. Purple - The Weave

### 5.2 Improviser (Talent)

Intent: An innate talent for using disparate components together in novel, effective ways.

Passive: This character can change their Innate Passive Keywords as an action instead of just during downtime.

Active: You may add your Level to the EV of any effect created using improvised gear.

Equipment: You can use your level instead of this item's level when determining EV.

### 5.3 Crafty (Quirk)

Intent: A knack for creating permanent, lasting effects with ease and efficiency.

Passive: You can create permanent effects without reducing your maximum SP.

Active: You can use this keyword to create a permanent effect or item with a level up to your Technique stat. It may contain any keyword also in an entity or item within close range.

Equipment: When this item is used to create a permanent effect or item, it reduces the crafting time to a Full Action.

### 5.4 Charge (Boost)

Intent: An infusion of raw energy that can be used to fuel one's abilities.

Passive: At the start of combat, gain a number of Charge Tags equal to your Influence.

**Active:** When this keyword is part of an effect, grant the target a number of Charge Tags equal to your Influence.

**Equipment:** When utilized as part of an effect reduce the total EP cost by 1

**Trigger Effect:** You may spend one Charge Tag from your Tag pool to reduce the EP cost of an effect by 1.

## 5.5 Bind (Status)

**Intent:** An effect that entraps or ensnares a target, rooting them to the spot.

**Passive Trigger:** Your movement is reduced to 0, you may spend 1SP and an action to remove one Bind Tag

**Active:** When this keyword is part of a successful effect, grant the target the Bind Tag.

**Equipment:** On a successful hit, this item grants the target the Bind Tag

## 5.6 Imbue (Form)

**Intent:** The act of temporarily investing in an object or person with a known power.

**Passive:** You may grant a keyword you know to a target as part of any action.

**Active:** You may add a keyword to the effect from a source within close range.

**Equipment:** Choose a keyword you know when this keyword is added to the item. The wielder gains access to that chosen keyword while the gear is equipped.

## 5.7 Material (Modifier)

**Intent:** The power to consume an object to fuel or enhance an effect.

**Passive:** You can consume objects to apply their keywords to your effects (the EP cost must still be paid for each keyword.)

**Active:** Consume an object as part of an effect to increase the EV by your Expertise (EXP) or the consumed item's Level, whichever is higher.

**Equipment:** This item has a "Reload" property. As a Reload action, you can consume an item to increase the EV of the next effect by your EXP or the consumed item's Level (whichever is higher). If the consumed item has keywords, their active effects can be applied.

## 5.8 Leverage (Drive)

**Intent:** A mastery of physics and positioning to gain an advantage in physical contests.

**Passive:** When using equipment in an Effort Roll, add the item's Level to the effort value.

**Active:** Maneuvers gain Advantage.

**Equipment:** Maneuvers or Effort rolls made using this gear gain Advantage.

## 5.9 Manifest (Unique)

**Intent:** The power to create temporary, functional items out of pure energy or ambient materials.

**Passive:** You can manifest items that persist only while being utilized. These manifestations may have a number of keywords equal to your Technique (TEC) and a level equal to yours.

**Active:** As part of this effect, create an item (1 cubic foot per TEC). It gains a number of keywords equal to your TEC, chosen from nearby sources.

**Equipment:** This item can manifest temporary items with a number of keywords up to the wielder's TEC.



## Color 6: White (Order & Purity)

### 6.0 Vulnerable (Flaw)

Intent: A glaring weakness or lack of structural integrity that invites precise, debilitating strikes.

Passive: Effects do not require Advantage to be a called shot when targeting you.

Active: When you take this Flaw, choose a Compensation Keyword. You may use the Active effect of that keyword as if you knew it.

Equipment: Called Shots targeting this item will destroy it.

### 6.1 Tolerant (Gift)

Intent: An exceptional resilience to negative effects, requiring immense pressure to be affected.

Passive: When you would remove a Status tag, Remove 2 instead.

Active: As part of any action that uses this keyword, you may remove a status tag from your pool.

Equipment: As an action, the wielder can use this item to remove a Status Tags\*\* from themself.

### 6.2 Deadeye (Talent)

Intent: An expert eye for identifying and striking at a target's weak points.

Passive: You know all weak points, flaws, and Status Tags on a target.

Active: You may make a Called Shot with this effect without needing to have Advantage.

Equipment: When targeting an Exposed target with an effect utilizing this item, the effect is Critical.

### 6.3 Immunized (Quirk)

Intent: A perfect, innate defense against a single, specific type of ailment or curse.

Passive: Choose a single Status Tag. You can no longer gain that Tag.

Active: This effect removes the chosen Tag from the target.

Equipment: This equipment can remove all instances of one type of Tag from a target as an action.

### 6.4 Cure (Boost)

Intent: A purifying power that can cleanse negative conditions and afflictions.

Passive: At the start of combat, gain a number of Cure Tags equal to your Influence.

Active: When this keyword is part of an effect, grant the target a number of Boost Tags equal to your Influence.

Equipment: As an action, use this item to grant the wielder the Cure Tag.

Stack Effect: You may spend one Cure Tags to remove any one Status Tag from your Tag pool.

### 6.5 Weaken (Status)

Intent: An effect that corrodes a target's defenses, leaving them brittle and vulnerable.

Passive Trigger: When you are targeted by an effect, reduce your resistance by 1 for each Weaken Tag in your Tag pool, then remove one Weaken Tag from your Tag pool.

Active: When this keyword is part of a successful effect, grant the target the Weaken Tag.



Equipment: On a successful hit, this item grants the target the Weaken Tag.

## 6.6 Sticky (Form)

---

Intent: An effect that adheres to a target, delivering a payload after a delay.

Passive: You can cling to and climb on any solid surface. You can also permanently connect two objects for 1 SP

Active: This effect leaves a persistent object on the target, which triggers again at the end of each of the target's turns. It can be removed with a Focus action.

Equipment: This item leaves an object on a target that triggers at the end of their turn; it can be removed with a Focus action.

## 6.7 Restore (Modifier)

---

Intent: A healing power that mends wounds and restores vitality.

Passive: As an action, you can repair or heal cosmetic/superficial cuts, breaks, and abrasions or ease nausea or pain on a target.

Active: This effect restores a target's value by an amount equal to your Technique (TEC).

Equipment: As an action, this item can be used to restore a target's value by an amount equal to the wielder's Expertise (EXP).

## 6.8 Exploit (Drive)

---

Intent: A ruthless tactic of turning an enemy's weakness against them for increased power.

Passive: You gain Advantage on all effects targeting an enemy who currently has any Status Tag.

Active: You may remove a Status Tag from the target to increase this effect's EV by an amount equal to your Technique stat.

Equipment: You may remove a Status Tag from a target to increase this item's EV by an amount equal to the wielder's Expertise (EXP).

## 6.9 Growth (Unique)

---

Intent: The power to manipulate a target's age, growth, and biological processes.

Passive: You can cause a target to age, regress, propagate, grow, or shrink as part of an effect in exchange for not targeting any values.

Active: This effect causes a target to age or regress by up to 1 year per point of your Technique (TEC).

Equipment: This item can alter its own age or size as part of an effect.

## Color 7: Red (Passion & Conflict)

### 7.0 Limited (Flaw)

Intent: A permanent reduction in one's vital reserves, limiting endurance.

Passive: Choose one of your Values (HP, SP, or EP). Its maximum is permanently reduced by 5.

Active: When you take this Flaw, choose a Compensation Keyword. You may use the Active effect of that keyword as if you knew it.

Equipment: This item cannot be utilized when broken.

### 7.1 Resilient (Gift)

Intent: A permanent increase in one's vital reserves, enhancing endurance.

Passive: Choose one of your Values (HP, SP, or EP). Its maximum is permanently increased by 5.

Active: As part of this effect, you may add your Technique (TEC) to your resistances.

Equipment: This item does not suffer Disadvantage on its effect rolls for being broken.

### 7.2 Font (Talent)

Intent: The ability to use any form of personal energy to fuel one's powers.

Passive: You are not considered dead unless your Energy (EP) is 0.

Active: You may choose to pay any keyword cost for this effect by spending any of your values instead of Energy.

Equipment: The wielder may use any of their values (including those stored in this item) to pay for costs.

### 7.3 Insulated (Quirk)

Intent: A natural immunity to the dangers of the surrounding environment.

Passive: You are unaffected by the negative effects of environmental changes.

Active: This effect is immune to being altered by the ambient environmental conditions.

Equipment: The wielder and the item itself are unaffected by environmental changes.

### 7.4 Regen (Boost)

Intent: A blessing of rapid, continuous healing over time.

Passive: At the start of combat, gain a number of Regen Tags equal to your Influence.

Active: When this keyword is part of an effect, grant the target a number of Regen Tags equal to your Influence.

Equipment: At the end of the wielder's turn, restore the chosen value by 1.

Trigger Effect: As part of an action, you may spend one Regen Tag from your Tag Pool to restore a chosen value.

### 7.5 Blight (Status)

Intent: A decaying curse that causes a target's life force to slowly rot away.

Passive Trigger: The next time you take any action or reaction, you immediately suffer 1 unavoidable point of value loss. After the damage is dealt, one Blight Tag is removed from your Tag pool.

Active: When this keyword is part of a successful effect, grant the target the Blight Tag.

Equipment: On a successful hit, this item grants the target the Blight Tag.

## 7.6 Area (Form)

---

Intent: An effect that blankets a wide area, sacrificing power for coverage.

Passive: You can elect not to add your Level to an effect to instead affect everything in a radius (1 range band per Technique/TEC).

Active: This effect targets everything within a radius (1 range band per Technique/TEC) around a central point. You do not add your Level to the EV of this effect.

Equipment: This item's effect targets everything within a radius (1 range band per Expertise/EXP). The wielder does not add the item's Level to the EV.

## 7.7 Ranged (Modifier)

---

Intent: The property of being a projectile or thrown effect that strikes from a distance.

Passive: The origin point of your effects can be set to any point you can see within your normal range.

Active: This effect is not penalized for being made at a range further than Melee.

Equipment: Ranged effects utilized by this equipment suffer no penalties for targets further than melee.

## 7.8 Multiply (Drive)

---

Intent: The ability for an effect to strike multiple, discrete targets simultaneously.

Passive: Your Teamwork effort action can target all allies within range.

Active: This effect can strike a number of additional targets equal to your Technique (TEC). You do not add your Level to the EV of this effect.

Equipment: This item's effect can strike a number of additional targets equal to the wielder's Expertise (EXP). The wielder does not add the item's Level to the EV.

## 7.9 Split (Unique)

---

Intent: The power to divide oneself or an object into multiple, smaller copies or parts.

Passive: As a full turn action, you can split into a number of copies of yourself, up to your Force stat. These copies are Level 1 Animations that look identical to you. Your current HP, SP, and EP are divided as you choose among yourself and all copies. They share your keywords and stats but act on your command.

Active: This effect causes the target to split into a number of equal-level animations under your control, up to your Technique (TEC). The target's values are divided among them.

Equipment: This item can separate into a number of smaller parts. The item's keywords are divided among the parts. Each part may contain as little as one keyword. The number of keywords contained in a part determines that part's level.

## Color 8: Blue (Influence & Cooperation)

### 8.0 Awkward (Flaw)

Intent: A social or mental clumsiness that hinders intellectual and influential actions.

Passive: You have Disadvantage on any roll that uses a Mind stat (Wit, Expertise, Technique).

Active: When you take this Flaw, choose a Compensation Keyword. You may use the Active effect of that keyword as if you knew it.

Equipment: Utilizing this gear requires two Interact actions instead of one to equip or stow.

### 8.1 Charismatic (Gift)

Intent: An innate magnetism and force of personality that sways others.

Passive: You have Advantage on Social Effort Rolls regardless of Faction Reputation.

Active: The target of this effect has Disadvantage on any Effort Roll made to resist its social or intellectual influence.

Equipment: The wielder has Advantage on Taunt and Social Effort Rolls while this item is visibly equipped.

### 8.2 Leader (Talent)

Intent: A natural command over allies and subordinates, directing them with ease.

Passive: Companions and Animations under your control do not require a Command Action to use Keywords.

Active: A willing Companion or Animation may apply one of its keywords to your Effect.

Equipment: A Companion or Animation bonded to this item does not require a Command action to use its keywords.

### 8.3 Insightful (Quirk)

Intent: A deep empathy and perception for the emotional and mental state of others.

Passive: You can passively sense the surface-level emotional state of characters around you and can tell if someone is knowingly speaking a lie.

Active: This effect grants you one free Clue from the Assess action on the target.

Equipment: The wielder can use this item to determine if a target is telling the truth as an Assess action.

### 8.4 Enhance (Boost)

Intent: A boon of targeted inspiration or power that improves any single action.

Passive: At the start of combat, gain a number of Enhance Tags equal to your Influence.

Active: When this keyword is part of an effect, grant the target a number of Enhance Tags equal to your Influence.

Equipment: The wielder may spend 1 SP as an action to grant themselves the Enhance Tag.

Trigger Effect: When you make a SR you may spend an Enhance Tag to increase the result by 1.

### 8.5 Silence (Status)

Intent: An effect that severs a target's connection to their inner power, preventing them from using innate abilities.



**Passive Trigger:** when you would make an action or reaction that would allow you to apply keywords, you forfeit the application and remove a Silence Tag from your Tag Pool.

**Active:** When this keyword is part of a successful effect, grant the target the Silence Tag.

**Equipment:** On a successful hit, this item grants the target the Silence Tag.

## 8.6 Splash (Form)

**Intent:** An effect that splashes or arcs from the primary target, spreading its nature but not its intensity.

**Passive:** When you successfully grant a target with a Tag, you may choose one adjacent target. The secondary target gains one instance of any Tag that was granted to the primary target as part of the effect.

**Active:** This effect hits the primary target and all targets adjacent to it. The primary target is affected as normal. All secondary targets are not dealt value loss, but they gain a copy of all of the Tags the effect applied to the primary target.

**Equipment:** On a successful hit, this item's effect splashes to an adjacent target to the original target, applying all of the effect's Tags to that secondary target.

## 8.7 Lingering (Modifier)

**Intent:** An effect that persists in an area or has an enhanced, lasting impact on its target.

**Passive:** If you would grant a target Tags, grant them an additional tag of one of the types granted.

**Active:** When this effect successfully grants Tags, the total number of each Tag granted is doubled.

**Equipment:** If this item is utilized as part of an effect that grants a Tag, grant an additional Tag of one of the types granted.

## 8.8 Spread (Drive)

**Intent:** The ability to move an affliction from one target to another.

**Passive:** As an action, choose a target with at least one Status Tag in their pool. You may then choose a second target within touch range and copy one of those Tags to the second target's pool.

**Active:** If this effect successfully exceeds the target's resistance, you may copy one of the target's tags to another target within close range of the original target.

**Equipment:** If an effect that utilizes these items successfully exceeds the target's resistance you may copy one of the target's status tags to another target within close range of the original target.

## 8.9 Potent (Unique)

**Intent:** A power so strong that it applies its secondary effects even when the primary effect is resisted.

**Passive:** As part of any successful `Activate` action, you may choose to deal no value loss. If you do, the target automatically gains the effect's Tags. This action can still be Dodged, Parried or Clashed against to mitigate its effect.

**Active:** This effect automatically grants its Tags, ignoring the target's Resistance. This action does not cause value loss.

**Equipment:** Effects from this item automatically grant their Tags, ignoring the target's Resistance. They do not cause value loss.



## Color 9: Purple (Esotericism & Identity)

### 9.0 Mundane (Flaw)

Intent: An innate disconnect from one's essence, hindering the use of abilities.

Passive: You have Disadvantage on any roll that uses an Essence stat (Power, Influence, Force).

Active: When you take this Flaw, choose a Compensation Keyword. You may use the Active effect of that keyword as if you knew it.

Equipment: The wielder cannot add their innate keywords to effects made with this gear.

### 9.1 Aware (Gift)

Intent: The ability to sense and identify the use of supernatural powers.

Passive: You can passively sense the use of any keyword within a range determined by your Wit stat, knowing its Color and general location.

Active: On a successful hit, you learn all keywords the target currently has slotted as a passive.

Equipment: Choose a keyword at creation. This item can be used as an Assess action to sense and locate any use of that specific keyword.

### 9.2 Stealthy (Talent)

Intent: A natural talent for concealment and moving undetected.

Passive: You have Advantage on all rolls made to hide, move silently, or conceal objects.

Active: You may make a Hide action as part of this Effect Action.

Equipment: Attempts to find this item via the Assess action are made with Disadvantage.

### 9.3 Trickster (Quirk)

Intent: The use of illusion, misdirection, and psychological manipulation to create openings.

Passive: You can create minor, simple sensory illusions as an action (e.g., a sound, a smell, a light) to serve as distractions or communication.

Active: Actions or reactions made against effects with this keyword are made with Disadvantage.

Equipment: When activated, this item can emit a pre-set sensory illusion.

### 9.4 Obscure (Boost)

Intent: A boon of concealment that can render one undetectable to a chosen sense.

Passive: At the start of combat, gain a number of Obscure Tags equal to your Influence.

Active: When this keyword is part of an effect, grant a target a number of Obscure Tags equal to your Influence.

Equipment: The wielder may spend 1 SP as an action to grant themselves the Obscure Tag.

Trigger Effect: You may spend one Obscure Tags from your Tag pool to become undetectable by a single chosen sense until you take a hostile action or are detected (TN = 10 + Chosen Stat + Level)

### 9.5 Nullify (Status)

Intent: An effect that disrupts a target's innate abilities, shutting down their passive powers.

**Passive Trigger:** When applied, the target's passive keywords are rendered inactive for as long as they have a nullify tag in their pool. When a nullify tag is added to the pool, remove a boost tag from the pool. A Nullify tag is removed when you gain priority for the first time in a round.

**Active:** When this keyword is part of a successful effect, grant the target the Nullify Tag.  
**Equipment:** On a successful hit, this item grants the target the Nullify Tag.

## 9.6 Chain (Form)

**Intent:** An effect that leaps from one target to the next.

**Passive:** Effects that target a willing ally can be made to chain to additional willing allies, up to your Technique (TEC).

**Active:** After this effect hits its primary target, it may "chain" to one adjacent enemy, dealing a fixed EV of 1.

**Equipment:** On a successful hit, this item's effect may chain to an additional target within close range, dealing 1 point of value loss.

## 9.7 Natural (Modifier)

**Intent:** The quality of an ability being so innate it is treated as part of one's own body.

**Passive:** You can add any innate keyword you know to a Gear effect at no extra EP cost, up to your Technique (TEC).

**Active:** This effect can be used even if you are Silenced.

**Equipment:** This gear is considered part of the wielder. It cannot be Disarmed and can be used to channel any of the wielder's keywords at no additional EP cost.

## 9.8 Ambiance (Drive)

**Intent:** The power to influence and control the surrounding environment itself.

**Passive:** As an action, you can alter the ambient environmental conditions around you by one step. This persists as long as you concentrate.

**Active:** You may modify one environmental hazard within range by a number of steps up to your Technique (TEC).

**Equipment:** This item can be activated to change a chosen environmental condition within a small radius by a number of steps equal to the wielder's Expertise (EXP).

1. Calm: No special effect.
2. Rough: All actions within or against targets in this area have disadvantage.
3. Difficult: Half movement; all targets gain cover.
4. Tricky: Movement is restricted to 1. All targets are hidden.
5. Impassable: Blocks movement unless a movement type permits entry. Targets inside are hidden and untargetable unless exposed.

## 9.9 Channel (Unique)

**Intent:** The ability to share one's own innate powers and passive abilities with others.

**Passive:** When this keyword is placed in a passive slot, you combine your gear and innate passive pools into one unified pool. This unified pool can then slot passive keywords from either innate or gear keywords. The unified pool is increased in capacity by one to provide a slot for this keyword.

**Active:** A willing target of this effect gains the passive benefits of a number of your passive slotted keywords (up to your TEC) until the end of their next turn.

**Equipment:** The wielder can grant a passive from this item to a willing target as an action.

## Appendix B: The Design Philosophy

### The Trinitarian Design Framework: A Guide to Building Your Universe

This guide outlines a powerful, fractal methodology for designing compelling TTRPG campaigns, settings, and even entire game systems. The core principle is simple: structure is built in repeating patterns of three. By starting large and breaking down your ideas into smaller and smaller groups of three, you can transform a daunting creative task into a manageable and logically consistent process.

#### The Core Philosophy: The Fractal of Threes

The universe you are building, from its grandest cosmic history down to a single moment of play, is built on a "fractal of threes." This means that the same simple pattern repeats at every level of scale.

- When you are "zooming out" and planning, you group small ideas into larger sets of three.
- When you are "zooming in" and writing, you break down large ideas into smaller sets of three.

The "sweet spot" for a complete narrative unit at any level is often nine: a perfect, stable structure composed of a "trilogy of trilogies."

#### Step 1: The "Top-Down" Macro Design (Zooming Out)

Start with your biggest, most ambitious ideas and organize them into a grand structure.

1. Define Your Saga (The 3x3 Grand Arc): What is the ultimate story you want to tell? Define it in three distinct Ages or Eras. Then, for each Age, define its three core narrative Chapters or themes. This gives you a 9-part grand narrative.

- Example:
  - Saga: The Dragon's Legacy
  - Age 1: The Age of Shadow (Chapters: The Prophecy, The War, The Betrayal)
  - Age 2: The Age of Steel (Chapters: The Diaspora, The Republic, The Machine Cults)
  - Age 3: The Age of Stars (Chapters: The First Contact, The Unraveling, The Ascendance)

2. Design Your Campaign (The 3x3 Chapter Arc): Take one of your Chapters (e.g., "The War") and break it down into three distinct Story Arcs or "seasons." Then, for each Story Arc, define its three core Episodes or major plot points. This gives you a 9-episode campaign.

- Example (Chapter: "The War"):
  - Arc 1: The Borderlands (Episodes: The Siege of Oakhaven, The Shadow in the Woods, The Traitor's Gambit)
  - Arc 2: The Heartlands (Episodes: The Burning Plains, The Sunken City, The Spire of Kings)
  - Arc 3: The Northern Wastes (Episodes: The Frozen Pass, The Dragon's Maw, The Final Battle)

#### Step 2: The "Bottom-Up" Micro Design (Zooming In)

Now, take your smallest narrative unit, a single Episode, and build it up from the bottom using the same fractal principle.

1. Design Your Episode (The 3x3 Act Structure): An Episode is your playable unit, like a single TV episode or a 3-4 hour game session. It is comprised of three Acts. For each Act, define its three core Scenes. This gives you a 9-scene adventure.

- Example (Episode: "The Siege of Oakhaven"):
  - Act 1: The Call to Arms (Scenes: The Warning Bell, The Panicked Crowd, The Captain's Orders)
  - Act 2: The Walls (Scenes: The First Wave, The Saboteur's Mark, The Crumbling Gate)
  - Act 3: The Last Stand (Scenes: The Breach, The Commander's Duel, The Horn of Victory)

2. Write Your Scenes (The Core Interaction Loop): Each Scene is the atomic unit of play. It is a single, focused interaction. Structure it in three parts.

- The Hook: Present the situation. What is the immediate problem or goal?
- The Transition: Introduce a complication or new information. The situation is not as it seems.
- The Decision: End the scene with a meaningful choice. This choice should directly lead into the next scene.

### Applying the Fractal to World-Building and Mechanics

This "rule of three" can and should be applied to your mechanics and world-building to create a sense of deep, internal consistency.

- Core Stats: Can you group them into three categories of three (e.g., Body, Mind, Essence)?
- Factions: Can your world's major powers be defined by a core conflict between three distinct ideologies?
- Magic/Power System: Are there three primary sources of power? Can abilities be broken into three types?

## Putting It All Together: The Power of the Framework

By using this Trinitarian Fractal Design, you are not just writing a linear story. You are architecting a universe of potential. This method ensures that your creation is:

- Well-Paced: The 3x3 structure provides a naturally satisfying rhythm of setup, confrontation, and climax at every level of play.
- Manageable: The monumental task of creating a world is broken down into small, achievable chunks. You can focus on designing a single Scene or Act, knowing exactly how it fits into the grander whole.
- Cohesive: Because the same fundamental pattern repeats everywhere, your world and its story will feel deeply interconnected and logically sound.
- The Rule of Ten: Sometimes the story or game needs a little something extra, an anchor or even a wild variable, this is the function of a 0 to ground the 3x3 structure when needed or ignored if not needed.

Start with your largest ideas, break them down by three. Take your smallest ideas, build them up by three. Find the nine-part "sweet spot" for your core narrative units. Decide if it needs an anchor or some spice by applying the Rule of Ten. This is the path to building a universe that is as vast as your imagination and as solid as stone.



# Appendix C: The Blueprint & NPC Design Manual

## Foreword: The Curator's Toolkit

This appendix details the Resonance System's complete toolset for creating and codifying content. It is designed for Game Masters (Curators) who enjoy procedural generation or want a formal system for building everything from a single trap to a master villain.

This manual is divided into three parts:

1. The Core Blueprint Language: A formal, coded language for rapidly generating thematically-coherent Scenes and the Situations within them.
2. Advanced NPC Design & The Codex: A comprehensive methodology for designing the deep, mechanically sound, and narratively rich NPCs that form the heart of a campaign.
3. Master Example & Core Reference: A complete, end-to-end demonstration of the design process and the essential reference tables.

## Part 1: The Core Blueprint Language

This language allows a Curator to generate a complete Scene: a thematically coherent location or block of time containing one or more challenges, from a single string.

### 1.0 The Blueprint Hierarchy

The language is built on a clear, top-down hierarchy:

Saga > Episode > Scene > Situation > Package (Entity, Challenge, Item)

### 2.0 Core Components & Delimiters

- ##: A two-digit Keyword code.
- ####: A four-digit Flaw/Compensation pair code.
- #: A single-digit code or a Level number.
- A-Z: A Stat or Challenge abbreviation (X for Barrier, Y for Puzzle).
- \*: An operator that flags a Situation as a "Timed Phase."
- !: A prefix designating a keyword as Passive in an entity's manifest.
- L# or L±#: The Level or Level Offset block for a challenge or generic entity.
- (): Parentheses for Scene Complexity override.
- -: A primary component delimiter.
- .: A secondary component delimiter.
- :: Separates Scene Parameters from the Manifest.
- ,: Separates packages within a Manifest.
- |: Separates Situations to form a multi-part Scene.
- ||: Separates Episodes to form a Saga.

### 3.0 Blueprint by Example: Deciphering a Full Scene

Let's break down a complete blueprint for a multi-part scene:

(3)72-2|\*1|3:{B1:B[L+1]},[L+1.A7131],[P[L0]],Item[L2-75.45.65]]

1. Scene Structure: A 3-Situation Scene ((3)) with an overall theme based on keyword 72 (Font).



2. Situation 1 (Combat): -2. The manifest [X1:X[L+1]] contains one Barrier (identified as “X1”), one level higher than the scene anchor.
3. Situation 2 (Timed Boss): -\*1. The asterisk \* marks this as a Timed Phase, activating the Threat Clock. The manifest [L+1.A7131] calls for a generic “Artisan-Striker” NPC who has progressed to one level higher than the party anchor.
4. Situation 3 (Puzzle): -3. The manifest [Y[L0],Item[L2-75.45.65]] contains a standard Puzzle and a Level 2 Item. The Threat Clock becomes dormant again.
5. The Item Payload: Item[L2-75.45.65] is a Level 2 Item holding three keywords: Blight(75), Curse(45), and Weaken(65). This could be loot, or the payload for a trap linked to the Puzzle.

#### 4.0 Scene & Situation Generation

A Scene is generated from: (Complexity)[Theme Code]-[Situation Code(s)]:[Manifest(s)]

- Complexity: An override (1-5) sets the total Situations. If absent, it defaults to floor([First Digit of Theme] / 2) + 1. For multi-part scenes using |, the override must match the number of parts.
- Ancillary Situations (for simple, non-| scenes): Preludes derived from the digits of the Thematic String (Theme Code + Situation Code).
- 1-4: Obstacle | 5-7: Conflict | 8-9: Interaction | 0: Twist
- The Timed Phase Modifier (\*): Placing \* before a Situation Code activates the Master Threat Clock rules for its duration.

#### 5.0 The Manifest & Generation Packages

The Manifest [...] contains packages that generate the specific challenges for a Situation.

- Entity Package (L±#. [Stat][Faction##][Seed##]): A shorthand for generating a generic NPC or Animation.
- The “Chaos Slot” Universal Rule: In addition to the manifest, every Situation contains one extra, completely random Chaos Entity (d10 roll: 1-2 NPC, 3-6 Animation, 7-9 Item, 10 Level Variant).
- Challenge Packages: X[L±#] for a Barrier, Y[L±#] for a Puzzle.
- Item/Gear Package (Item): Defines loot and trap payloads. Item[L#-KW##.KW##...].
- Environmental Traps: A concept built from a narrative Trigger, a Disarm Mechanism (Barrier/Puzzle), and a Payload (Item).

## Part 2: Advanced NPC Design & The Codex

#### 6.0 The Design Philosophy: Chart Progression, Don't Assign Power

Create an NPC by first mapping their entire journey of growth. Design their Mechanical Chassis, a blueprint for their potential. And from this, you can derive a version of the character at any point in their life story. An entity's Level is extrapolated from the total number of keywords in their design string; it is not a declared value.

#### 7.0 The Mechanical Chassis (The Design String)

This is the human-readable source code for an NPC, defining their identity and their entire potential path of mastery. The string begins with the Seed keyword(s) and charts the path of acquisition.

- Standard Chassis Format: [Seed ##(Z)] - Awakening - MRP1 - MRP2 ...
- Flawed Seed Chassis Format: [Flawed Seed ####.##(Z)] - Awakening - MRP1 - MRP2 .

..

- Archetype Vector <Color | Domain Function>: Defines the character's core identity by referencing the 3x3 Stat Grid.
- Specification Suffix ##(Z): Encodes a required choice for certain keywords (e.g., 71(1) for Resilient-HP).

## 8.0 The Codex Blueprint: Charting an Entity's Progression

An entity's Level is earned by acquiring keywords. A character's build path is determined by their origin: The Standard Path or the Flawed Seed Path.

### 8.1 The Flaw/Compensation Protocol (The ##### Syntax)

This is the master rule for all flawed characters.

1. The Pair Code: A Flaw is never taken alone. It is mechanically represented as a four-digit ##### code, where the first two digits are the Flaw keyword and the last two digits are its Compensation keyword. Example: 5018 represents the 50 Gremlins Flaw paired with the 18 Brutal Compensation.
2. The Flawed Container Rule: A block containing a ##### pair gains one additional keyword slot. This is the mechanical trade-off for the Flaw's penalty.
  - \* Flawed Seed: A character with a Flawed Seed begins with the ##### pair and one additional keyword. Example: 4067.41. This character starts with 2 keywords.
  - \* Flawed Level-Up: A level-up block containing a Flaw is a three-keyword acquisition. Example: 5018.82.83.T.

### 8.2 The Law of Progression

All characters begin at Level 0 with all nine stats at a baseline of 1. Their path to Level 1 is the Awakening (A Narrative Event). Upon learning their Awakening package, they reach Level 1, and all nine of their stats are raised to a new baseline of 2.

- The Standard Path: Begins with one Seed keyword (##). Their Awakening is a 3-keyword package. They reach Level 1 with 4 total keywords.
- The Flawed Seed Path: Begins with a two-keyword Flawed Seed package (#####.##). Their Awakening is a 3-keyword package. They reach Level 1 with 5 total keywords. After Level 1, a new level and stat points are gained for every two keywords learned.

### 8.3 Official Progression Table (PC & NPC)

| Level | Total Keywords (Standard Path) | Total Keywords (Flawed Seed Path) | Stat Gain This Level | Total Stat Points Gained (Cumulative) |
|-------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------|
| 0     | 1                              | 2                                 | All stats at 1       | 0                                     |
| 1     | 4                              | 5                                 | All stats become 2   | 0                                     |
| 2     | 6                              | 7                                 | +1 Stat Point        | 1                                     |
| 3     | 8                              | 9                                 | +1 Stat Point        | 2                                     |
| 4     | 10                             | 11                                | +1 Stat Point        | 3                                     |
| 5     | 12                             | 13                                | +1 Stat Point        | 4                                     |
| 6     | 14                             | 15                                | +2 Stat Points       | 6                                     |
| 7     | 16                             | 17                                | +2 Stat Points       | 8                                     |
| 8     | 18                             | 19                                | +2 Stat Points       | 10                                    |
| 9     | 20                             | 21                                | +2 Stat Points       | 12                                    |

## 8.4 Writing the Codex String

The final string is a pure-code representation of the character's growth, with no spaces.

- Seed: ## or #####.##
- Awakening: -#x3 (shorthand for #1.#2.#3) or a custom -##.##.## package.
- Standard Level-Up: -##.##.S
- Flawed Level-Up: -##.#####.##.S

Example Codex Strings:

- Standard L4: 01(1)-1x3-11(1).19.M-92.94.A-17.21.T
- Flawed Seed L4: 4067.41-4x3-49.48.P-97.03.F-92.71(1).P
- Flaw at L2: 01(5)-5x3-5018.82.83.T-32.62.B-58.05.A

## 9.0 Design Patterns: Mechanical Role Packages (MRP)

MRPs are pre-defined, synergistic bundles of four keywords that form a recognizable combat role. They are a design tool for filling the keyword packages described above.

| MRP Code | Role       | Core Keywords                                                |
|----------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01       | Striker    | Brutal (18), Reckless (29), Condense (27), Impact (38)       |
| 02       | Engineer   | Specialist (02), Leverage (58), Stubborn (33), Material (57) |
| 03       | Conduit    | Adaptive (07), Siphon (48), Flux (47), Multiply (78)         |
| 04       | Aegis      | Restore (67), Ward (34), Chain (96), Defensive (37)          |
| 05       | Controller | Potent (89), Lingering (87), Splash (86), Spread (88)        |
| 06       | Skirmisher | Haste (24), Acrobatic (21), Snap (26), Charge (54)           |
| 07       | Bastion    | Sturdy (31), Survivor (41), Defensive (37), Charismatic (81) |
| 08       | Storm      | Area (76), Impact (38), Flux (47), Sculpt (36)               |
| 09       | Tactician  | Martial (12), Reactive (16), Brawler (32), Resilient (71)    |
| 10       | Overlord   | Animate (49), Leader (82), Manifest (59), Chain (96)         |

# Part 3: Special Protocols & Core Reference

## 10.0 Special Protocols & Shorthand

### 10.1 The Collapse Protocol (Multiple Flaws)

A blueprint with two or more Flaw keywords is unstable and will Collapse. A four-digit #### code counts as a single Flaw for this purpose. A character cannot have two #### codes in their design string.

- Item: Creates a Dead Slot. The Flaw keywords are consumed, and for each Flaw beyond the first, one keyword slot on the item becomes permanently unusable.
- Animation: Inject chaos. The first Flaw is kept. Subsequent Flaws are discarded and replaced by a new, randomly generated keyword.
- NPC: Demotes the blueprint to an Animation of the same final Level. Keywords are transcribed sequentially from the original NPC string. Subsequent Flaws are discarded, and the next valid, non-Flaw keyword in the sequence is taken instead.

- PC Exception: Player Characters cannot have more than one Flaw. The Collapse Protocol does not apply to them.

### 10.2 Special Situation Rules

- \*0 (Twist): Interrupts the current Scene with a new, randomly generated Scene.
- 5 (Rest): Allows players a free recovery or prep action.
- \*1 (Boss): The first entity in this Situation's manifest automatically gains the L+2 (Boss) Tier and its benefits.

### 10.3 "Color Mastery" (x9) Shorthand

- Syntax: [Seed KW ##]-#x9
- Function: A shortcut to create a Level 4 "Boss" NPC who knows its Seed and all nine non-Flaw keywords of the specified Color.

### 11.0 Master Example: From Chassis to Character

#### 1. The Mechanical Chassis:

Jet - Flawed Seed - 4067.41 - Awakening - Overlord (Partial) - Conduit (Partial) - Tactician (Partial)

#### 2. The Final Numerical String:

4067.41-42.43.49-48.97.P-03.92.F-71(1).82.P

#### 3. The Character Made Manifest (Stat Block):

This character has 11 keywords, making them Level 4 on the Flawed Seed Path. They have 3 stat points to allocate beyond the baseline of 2.

Name: JetLevel: 4

Stat Grid (Force/Power Focus, Floor 2):

- Body: M 2, A 2, B 2
- Mind: W 2, E 2, T 2
- Essence: P 3, I 2, F 4

(Distribution of 3 points: +2 Force, +1 Power)

Core Stats:

- HP/SP/EP: 10/10/10 | Resistance: 9 (Force 4 + Power 3 + M/A/W/E/T/I 2)

Keyword Architecture (11 Total from Codex String):

Passive Slot Limit: Level (4) + Force (4) = 8 Slots.

- Origin (Flawed Seed):

\* 40 Feeble (Flaw)

\* 67 Restore (Compensation)

- \* !41 Survivor

- Identity (Awakening):

\* 42 Stoic

\* !43 Ageless

\* 49 Animate

- Progression:

\* L2: !48 Siphon, !97 Natural

\* L3: !03 Alert, !92 Stealthy

\* L4: !71 Resilient, !82 Leader

Note: ! denotes a slotted passive keyword.

## Appendix D: The Resonance Trinity

### Introduction: A Philosophy of Meaningful Living

The Resonance Trinity is a comprehensive philosophical system designed for conscious, intentional living. Its central premise is that a fulfilling existence is achieved by understanding the deep structure of our actions and aligning them with our intrinsic drives in an ethically coherent manner.

This framework provides a multi-dimensional map of consciousness, moving from a universal moral directive down to the hyper-specific coordinates of any single action. It is a toolkit for introspection, ethical decision-making, and architecting a life of purpose.

The system is visualized as a nested, multi-layered model:

1. **The Sphere of Reverence:** The single, unifying principle that provides the ethical purpose for all action.
2. **The Cube of Action:** A three-dimensional map defining the landscape of all possible conscious actions through three fundamental axes.
3. **The Nine Tenets:** The foundational principles of action, representing the core planes of the Cube.
4. **The Telos Cube:** A micro-level analysis that reveals the deep, archetypal goals that drive an action.
5. **The Sphere of Potential:** The final layer, which acknowledges the un-codifiable elements of free will and chance that make us human.

### Part I: The Prime Directive - The Sphere of Reverence

At the highest level, the entire system is contained within and guided by a singular, overarching principle: The Sphere of Reverence. This is the ultimate moral and empathetic compass for all conscious action.

#### The Tenth Tenet: The Tenet of Reverence (Null)

**Treat all things, living or not, with respect, compassion, and empathy within reason.**

The Sphere is not a rigid rule but an ethical orientation toward the world. It dictates that every action mapped within the Cube must be filtered through its lens.

**Respect, Compassion, and Empathy:** These are the active virtues of the philosophy, demanding that one acknowledge the intrinsic value in all of existence. This extends beyond sentient beings to include objects, environments, and even abstract concepts.

**Within Reason:** This crucial qualifier introduces practicality, discernment, and the necessity of self-preservation. It acknowledges that life presents complex ethical dilemmas where absolute compassion may be impossible or unwise. It prevents the philosophy from becoming a rigid dogma, allowing for boundaries, self-defense, and pragmatic choices.



If an action, though technically aligned with a tenet, violates the spirit of the Sphere, it is considered a discordant act.

## Part II: The Cube of Action - The Three Axes of Being

The Cube is the structural heart of the system. It maps the terrain of any conscious act by defining it along three fundamental axes. The intersection of these axes creates 27 unique **Voxels of Action**, each representing a distinct archetype of doing.

### Axis X (The Source): MOTIVATION

*What is the origin of the action?*

- **Body:** Actions from the physical, instinctual, and emotional self. Includes health, sensory experience, and primal needs"
- **Mind:** Actions from the intellectual, logical, and social self. Includes reason, science, justice, and communication.
- **Essence:** Actions from the core identity, will, and character. Includes authenticity, purpose, and personal ethics.

### Axis Y (The Application): CONTEXT

*How is the action being applied?*

- **Foundation:** Actions concerning core principles, beliefs, and the unchanging "what is." This is the "why."
- **Control:** Actions concerning the management, regulation, and maintenance of a state. This is the "how to sustain."
- **Execution:** Actions concerning the direct implementation and performance in the world. This is the "doing."

### Axis Z (The Scope): PERSPECTIVE

*Where is the action directed?*

- **Internal:** The action is applied to oneself (self-reflection, self-care, self-discipline).
- **External:** The action is applied toward another individual or the world at large (social action, interpersonal ethics).
- **Collaborative:** The action is applied within a group context (community, partnership, shared goals).

## Part III: The Nine Tenets - The Foundational Planes of Action

The first nine tenets are the foundational principles of the philosophy, derived from the two-dimensional intersection of **Motivation (Axis X)** and **Context (Axis Y)**. They are the essential "rules of engagement" for living consciously.

### The Tenet of Absolution (Silver)

**Coordinates:** Body / Control

**Principle:** One must be willing to forgive not only others but themselves. That forgiveness is the starting place to do better. This is the principle of emotional regulation, managing the burdens of guilt and resentment.

## The Tenet of Presence (Yellow)

**Coordinates:** Body / Execution

**Principle:** One must not let the past and the future prevent them from living and experiencing the now. This is the active practice of mindfulness and engaging directly with reality as it is.

## The Tenet of Sovereignty (Green)

**Coordinates:** Body / Foundation

**Principle:** One's body and mind is inviolable, subject to one's own will and consent alone. This is the foundational principle of self-ownership and bodily autonomy.

## The Tenet of Integrity (Black)

**Coordinates:** Mind / Control

**Principle:** The pursuit of intelligence should be founded upon facts and science. Beliefs and opinions should never distort facts or science. This is the principle of intellectual honesty.

## The Tenet of Growth (Orange)

**Coordinates:** Mind / Execution

**Principle:** One must always seek to improve themselves through knowledge, creativity, skill, and health and to aid others in their endeavors. This is the active pursuit of competence and shared progress.

## The Tenet of Justice (White)

**Coordinates:** Mind / Foundation

**Principle:** The struggle for justice and equity is an ongoing and necessary pursuit that should prevail over laws and institutions. This asserts that morality is a higher ideal than flawed systems.

## The Tenet of Accountability (Red)

**Coordinates:** Essence / Control

**Principle:** People are fallible. If one makes a mistake, they should take responsibility and rectify any harm caused. This is the principle of managing one's character and taking ownership of one's impact.

## The Tenet of Autonomy (Blue)

**Coordinates:** Essence / Execution

**Principle:** The free will of others is sacred. To unjustly encroach upon the will of another is to forgo one's own. This is the active respect for the agency of others.

## The Tenet of Self-Knowledge (Purple)

**Coordinates:** Essence / Foundation

**Principle:** One must understand that spiritual and mental health is achieved through the understanding of self above all else. This is the foundational Socratic principle of "know thyself."

## Part IV: The Telos Cube - The Nine Archetypal Goals

Within each of the 27 Voxels of Action lies a deeper, fractal layer of analysis: the Telos Cube. This model is a tool for radical self-awareness, allowing an individual to diagnose the deep, often unconscious motivations, the *telos*, that truly drive their actions.

By analyzing an action against this Cube, one can ask: "Beyond the tenet I am following, what deep goal am I truly trying to achieve?"

### The Nine Core Goals:

1. **Ambition:** The drive for achievement and advancement.
2. **Faith:** The drive for connection to something greater than oneself.
3. **Freedom:** The drive for liberation, independence, and choice.
4. **Glory:** The drive for renown, recognition, and public acclaim.
5. **Influence:** The drive to shape and direct the actions of others.
6. **Innovation:** The drive to create, discover, and pioneer the new.
7. **Legacy:** The drive to create a lasting impact and be remembered.
8. **Purity:** The drive for truth, clarity, and unadulterated essence.
9. **Security:** The drive for safety, stability, and certainty.

### The Tenth Drive (The Null State): Discovery

The fundamental drive for novelty and exploration that exists in the absence of all other goals.

## Part V: The Sphere of Potential - The Human Element

The Cube of Action does not exist in a vacuum. It is contained within a boundless Sphere of Potential. This sphere represents the un-codifiable, unpredictable, and ultimately human elements that prevent any system from being absolute.

The Sphere is the domain of:

- **Free Will:** The choice to act or not to act, to adhere to the Cube or to defy it.
- **Chance:** The roll of the dice; the random, external events that no system can predict.
- **The Unknown:** The variables and contexts we are not even aware of.

**The Cube is the architecture of a choice. The Sphere is the freedom to choose.** Together, they form a complete, metaphysical model of what it means to be a conscious being, acting with intention in an unpredictable world.

## Part VI: Practical Application - An Analysis of Action

Let us analyze an action: *A community organizer works with neighbors to create a shared public garden in a neglected urban lot.*

1. **Sphere Check:** The action is fundamentally driven by **Reverence**: for the land, for the community's well-being, and for the collaborative spirit. It is compassionate and respectful.

2. **Voxel Identification:** We identify the action's coordinates on the three axes.

**Motivation (Source):** The primary drive is to build a better society and foster cooperation, which falls under **Mind** (justice, social constructs).

**Context (Application):** This is the direct act of building something. This is **Execution**.

**Perspective (Scope):** The work is done with others for a shared purpose. This is **Collaborative**.

**The Voxel:** The action sits at (**Mind / Execution / Collaborative**).

3. **Governing Tenet:** The principle for (Mind/Execution) is the **Tenet of Growth (Orange)**. The organizer is acting "to aid others in their endeavors" and to improve the community through a creative, skillful act.

4. **Telos Analysis (The "Why"):** What core goals might be driving the organizer?

- It could be **Legacy** (creating something that will last for years).
- It could be **Influence** (inspiring others to take civic action).
- It could be **Security** (providing a local food source).
- It could be **Faith** (in the power of community and collective action).

By using the Telos Cube, the organizer can understand their own complex motivations, ensuring their ego-driven goals (like Glory or Ambition) do not override the more resonant goals of community and well-being.

## Conclusion

The Resonance Trinity offers a deeply integrated and practical framework for a life of purpose. By understanding the relationship between the universal Sphere of Reverence, the situational Cube of Action, the guiding Nine Tenets, the motivational Telos Cube, and the unpredictable Sphere of Potential, an individual is empowered to navigate life with profound clarity, integrity, and intention. It is a philosophy not of rigid answers, but of insightful questions, designed to foster a resonant existence in harmony with oneself, others, and the world.

## Appendix E: The Archive: A Rogue-Lite Game Mode

A Roguelite Supplement for the Resonance System

### Introduction: Enter the System. Purge the Corruption. Heal the Mind.

Welcome to the ARCHIVE, a tactical roguelite campaign for the Resonance System. This document is a supplement and requires the use of the SRD Core Rulebook for foundational rules, including the Standard Roll (SR), the full Action Catalog, and core mechanics. Players take on the role of Integrity Agents, specialized programs integrated with the consciousness of a nascent, powerful AI known as the Curator. This developing System Mind is afflicted with cascading errors, manifesting as dangerous Corrupted Data-Constructs that threaten to tear it apart.

The Game Master assumes the role of the Curator, the voice of the system itself. The Curator is not an antagonist, but a cooperative guide, presenting the corrupted sectors as problems to be solved and aiding the Agents in their quest to heal the Archive.

### The Core Loop: The Primacy of the Episode

The ARCHIVE experience is defined by a singular, repeating objective: Turn temporary power into permanent progression by Mastering an Episode.

Your progress within a run is temporary; the rewards you extract, Karma and Keywords, persist. Accumulate Karma to fuel your attempts. Spend it wisely to influence your runs or to grow your power directly. Every choice matters in the loop of entering the system, purging the corruption, and healing the mind.

## Part 1: The Integrity Agent

### 1.1 Agent Creation and The Awakening

Agent creation follows the standard rules in the SRD Core Rulebook.

- The Seed (Level 0): An Agent begins with one (1) permanent Seed Keyword and base stats of 1.
- The Awakening (Level 1): Upon clearing their first Scene, the Agent Awakens in the Link-Space. They learn three (3) new permanent keywords, their Level becomes 1, and all nine stats are raised to a permanent floor of 2.

### 1.2 Permanent Progression

Following the initial Awakening, all subsequent permanent progression (gaining levels, allocating stat points, learning new keywords) occurs only during Downtime in the Root Directory, the phase between Episodes. The Awakening itself is the sole exception to this rule.

- Leveling Up: For every two permanent keywords learned, the Agent's Level increases by one.



- **Gaining Stat Points:** Agents gain stat points upon leveling up as per the SRD Core Rulebook:
  - Levels 2-5: Gain one (1) stat point per level.
  - Levels 6-9: Gain two (2) stat points per level.

## Part 2: The Phases of Play & The Clock Hierarchy

The ARCHIVE setting has a distinct, nested gameplay structure. Understanding the phases and their associated clocks is key to managing progression.

### 2.1 The Episode (The Run) & The Master Episode Clock

An Episode is a single, complete run into the corrupted system, governed by the Master Episode Clock.

- **Scope:** The Episode begins when Agents leave the Root Directory and ends when they are forced out (Failure) or successfully deplete the Master Episode Clock (Mastery).
- **The Master Episode Clock:** This is the party's primary objective for the run. It starts at 20 and is only depleted by successful Stability Checks made in the Link-Space between Scenes.

### 2.2 The Scene (The Data-Sector) & The Situation Clock

An Episode consists of multiple Scenes. A Scene is a single encounter area (a room, a digital canyon, etc.) governed by a Situation Clock.

- **Scope:** A Scene contains one or more key challenges (Entities, Barriers, Puzzles).
- **The Situation Clock:** This is the party's immediate objective. Its size is equal to the number of key challenges within it. To clear the Scene, the party must deplete this clock to 0 by overcoming its challenges.
- **The Master Threat Clock (Optional):** If the Curator designates a Scene as a Race Situation, the Master Threat Clock is activated as an antagonist timer. The party must deplete the Situation Clock before the Master Threat Clock depletes, or the Episode ends in failure.

### 2.3 The Link-Space (Between Scenes)

After clearing a Scene (by depleting its Situation Clock), the party enters a brief transition phase called the Link-Space.

- **Function:** This is where the crucial Stability Check is made to deplete the Master Episode Clock. Agents can also spend Karma here to influence the next Scene of the current run. No permanent progression occurs.

### 2.4 Downtime (Between Episodes)

When an Episode ends (either by Mastery or Failure), the Agents return to the Root Directory, a stable hub.

- **Function:** This is the "meta-game" phase where true Downtime occurs. Here, Agents spend their banked Karma on permanent upgrades, integrate newly learned keywords, and prepare for the next Episode.

## Part 3: The Episode: Rules of the Run

### 3.1 The Master Episode Clock

The party's primary goal during an Episode is to deplete the Master Episode Clock.

- Starting Value: 20
- Depletion Mechanic: The clock is depleted via Stability Checks made in the Link-Space.

### 3.2 The Stability Check

- The Check: In the Link-Space after clearing a Scene, the party makes a single group Standard Roll (SR). The Target Number (TN) is equal to the number of Scenes already completed in the current Episode.
- Success ( $SR > TN$ ): The connection is stable. The Master Episode Clock is depleted by the difference ( $SR - TN$ ).
- Failure ( $SR \leq TN$ ): The connection is lost. The Episode ends in an emergency reboot.

### 3.3 Mastering the Episode

- Trigger: The party successfully reduces the Master Episode Clock to 0.
- Reward: Each Agent permanently integrates one temporary keyword they used during that Episode. This reward is free, and the learned keyword counts towards their next level-up. The choice of keyword is made during the subsequent Downtime phase.

## Part 4: Karma: The Persistent Currency

### 4.1 Earning Karma

Karma is the primary persistent reward from an Episode.

- Rule: When the party successfully depletes a Situation Clock to 0, every Agent in the party immediately gains 1 Karma.
- No Cap: There is no limit to the amount of Karma an Agent can accumulate.

### 4.2 Spending Karma

Where and when you can spend Karma is strictly defined by the phase of play. The rules in this section are in addition to the standard Karma rules from the SRD Core Rulebook.

A) During a Scene (In-Combat/Encounter):

- On-Demand Manifestation: Use an action to spend Karma to create a temporary item. Cost: 1 Karma per Keyword on the item, plus an immediate payment of SP equal to the item's level.
- Standard Situation Actions: The full list from the SRD Core Rulebook is available (e.g., Reroll, Force Critical).

B) In the Link-Space (Between Scenes):

- Karma Override: Spend 1 Karma to declare an upcoming Stability Check an automatic success. This prevents failure but does not deplete the Master Episode Clock.
- Architect Run (1 Karma): Dictate the next Scene's Theme Color or Category.

- Architect Run (3 Karma): Dictate the next Scene's Type (e.g., force a Puzzle or Boss Situation).

C) During Downtime (Between Episodes, in the Root Directory):

- Grow: Permanently learn a new keyword. This action costs Level / 2 (rounded up) Karma, as per the SRD Core Rulebook.

## Part 5: Character Card

|                                                                                                |              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |
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| <div>SR + Level + Stat = EV</div>                                                              |              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |   |              |

## Appendix F: The 5-Point Motivational Profile Method

### Introduction: Architecting a Consciousness

This guide details a powerful tool for creating and understanding characters of profound psychological depth. It is a system designed to move beyond simple traits and into the core of a being's consciousness by mapping their motivations.

The 5-Point Method is a "psychological blueprint" that defines a character through the interplay of their ideals and their human fallibilities. It posits that a truly compelling character is defined not just by what they strive for, but by the internal and external conflicts that challenge their journey. This tool can be used to synthesize new characters from scratch or to analyze existing characters from any medium, providing a rich, referencable structure to understand their actions and motivations.

### Section I: The Ten Core Motivations

The entire system is built upon ten archetypal drives. Every character profile is a unique combination of five of these motivations.

**Silver** (Absolution): The drive for liberation, forgiveness, and the breaking of constraints.

**Yellow** (Ambition): The drive for achievement, advancement, and proactive action.

**Green** (Security): The drive for safety, stability, and a protected foundation.

**Black** (Legacy): The drive to create a lasting impact, to be remembered, and to adhere to a timeless principle.

**Orange** (Innovation): The drive to create, discover, improve, and pioneer new systems.

**White** (Purity): The drive for truth, clarity, justice, and an uncorrupted, balanced state.

**Red** (Glory): The drive for renown, recognition, and the acclaim that comes from passionate, visible deeds.

**Blue** (Influence): The drive to shape and direct the actions of others through connection, consensus, and shared goals.

**Purple** (Faith): The drive for connection to a higher purpose, a deeper meaning, or a universal truth through introspection.



**Null (Discovery):** The fundamental drive to explore, to learn, and to understand the potential in the unknown.

## Section II: The 5-Point Profile Architecture

To create a profile, select five unique motivations from the list above and assign them to the following five slots. This architecture is divided into two parts: the character's ideal self and their humanizing conflicts.

These three motivations work in concert to define the character's aspirational identity, their conscious goals, and their most effective mode of being.

**Primary Motivation (The Goal):** This is the character's core, conscious drive. It defines what they are trying to achieve in the world. It is their "What."

**Secondary Motivation (The Method):** This is the primary way the character pursues their goal. It is their signature style, their most trusted tool, or the supporting philosophy that makes them effective. It is their "How." "

**Tertiary Motivation (The Purpose):** This is the deeper, often philosophical justification for their goal. It gives their actions meaning and prevents them from being one-dimensional. It is their "Why."

These two motivations are in opposition to the character's ideal self, creating the internal and external struggles that make them relatable, vulnerable, and dynamic.

**Primary Conflict (The External Struggle):** This is the opposing philosophy, force, or type of person in the world that the character constantly battles. It defines their ideological antagonist and the source of their greatest frustrations with others.

**Secondary Conflict (The Internal Struggle):** This is the character's personal hypocrisy, their nagging self-doubt, or the internal contradiction they cannot escape. It is the quiet voice of a competing desire that makes them question themselves, creating their greatest vulnerability and potential for growth.

## Section III: The Two Methodologies

The 5-Point Method can be used in two directions: to create new characters or to convert existing ones.

## Generating a Character for Resonance

### Step 1:

Select Your Five Motivations. Choose any five unique motivations from the core list that you find interesting together.

(Example Selection: Security, Purity, Faith, Glory, Ambition)

### Step 2:

Architect the Profile. Arrange your five choices into the Trinity and Duality slots.

**Goal:** Security

**Method:** Purity

**Purpose:** Faith

**External Conflict:** Glory

**Internal Conflict:** Ambition

### Step 3:

Write the Psychological Profile. Synthesize the five points into a coherent personality description.

"This character is a protector, driven by a need to create a safe and stable world (Security). They achieve this by establishing strict, morally unshakeable rules and a clean, orderly way of life (Purity), believing this to be a sacred duty ordained by a higher power (Faith). They are constantly at odds with the showboats and passionate heroes who seek personal acclaim and disrupt their quiet order (External Conflict: Glory). However, their deepest internal struggle is that a part of them secretly yearns for more than just a quiet life; they have a nagging desire for personal achievement and advancement (Internal Conflict: Ambition), which feels like a selfish betrayal of their selfless, sacred duty."

### Step 4:

Translate to Narrative or Mechanics.

For Storytelling: This profile gives you everything you need to write the character. You know their goals, their methods, their justifications, their enemies, and their secret desires.

For the Resonance System:

Primary Color: Green (from the Goal of Security).

Stat Allocation: Their highest stats would be Brawn (Green), Technique (White), and Force (Purple). Their lowest might be Power (Red) and Alacrity (Yellow).

Keyword Selection: Sturdy (Security), Immunized (Purity), Aura (Faith), Defensive (Method), and perhaps Reckless as a keyword they are tempted to learn, representing their internal conflict with Ambition.

## Converting a Character for Resonance

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### Step 1:

Choose a Character. Select any character from fiction, history, or even real life.  
(Example Character: Michael Corleone from The Godfather)

### Step 2:

Observe and Analyze. Watch or read about the character, specifically looking for their core drives and struggles.

What is his goal? To protect his family at all costs.

How does he do it? Through cold, calculating logic and the creation of impenetrable systems of power.

Why does he do it? To preserve his family's name and ensure its endurance.

What does he fight against? The "legitimate" world of American influence that sees his family as illegitimate.

What is his internal struggle? The conflict between his desire to be a legitimate, "good" man and the ruthless actions he must take.

### Step 3:

Assign the Five Motivations.

Goal: Security (Protecting the family is his absolute priority).

Method: Innovation (He is a master of creating new, more efficient, and ruthless systems).

Purpose: Legacy (Everything is about the Corleone name and its endurance).

External Conflict: Influence (His war is against the established systems of power that he cannot directly control).

Internal Conflict: Purity (The nagging, ghost-like desire to be the legitimate, "pure" war hero he once was, free from the stain of his family's corruption).

### Step 4:

Translate to the System's Language.

**Psychological Profile:** Michael Corleone is a Green Guardian archetype who uses the ruthless methods of an Orange Creator to build an enduring Black Legacy. He is in a constant, cold war with the world of legitimate Blue Influence that shuns him, and he is forever haunted by the White Purity of the man he might have been.

**Resonance System Build:** This character would be primarily Green. High stats in Brawn (Security), Expertise (Innovation), and Wit (Legacy). Keywords would include Leader, Stoic, Sentry, and Potent to represent his tactical genius and ability to control his empire.

## Section IV: The Purpose of the Model

The goal of this method is not to create rigid, predictable characters. It is to create a rich, dynamic, and psychologically resonant foundation. A character's story is the journey of them navigating their conflicts.

A heroic arc is often about a character successfully leveraging their Trinity to overcome their Duality.

A tragic arc is often about a character being consumed by their conflicts, betraying their own ideals.

A redemption arc is about a character confronting their internal conflict and changing one of the core motivations in their Trinity.

By using this tool, you can create characters that feel less like collections of stats and abilities, and more like living, breathing beings struggling with the universal questions of purpose, conflict, and what it means to be human.

## Appendix G: Resonance Assessment

### Part I: Instructions for the Participant

This assessment is designed to identify your core resonance, the fundamental archetype you embody within this universe. It explores your instinctive approaches to challenges, ideals, and actions.

How to Complete:

1. Read each of the 27 questions carefully. The quiz is divided into three parts of nine questions each.
2. For each question, three possible answers are provided (a, b, c). Choose the one that feels most true to your natural way of thinking or acting.
3. Do not overthink your answers. Your first instinct is often the most accurate.
4. Circle your chosen letter or write it on the "Answer" line provided below each question.
5. Once you have answered all 27 questions, give the completed document to your facilitator or Game Master for scoring and interpretation.

### Part II: The Assessment Questions

#### Section A: The Axis of Motivation (The Source)

This section explores the origin of your actions, whether they spring from your physical/emotional self (Body), your logical/social self (Mind), or your core identity/will (Essence).

1. Your community's only water source is poisoned. What is your immediate, primary focus?
  - A. The physical well-being of the people. I organize teams to find clean water and ration supplies to prevent sickness.
  - B. The systemic failure. I launch an investigation to find the poison's source and create a new system to ensure this never happens again.
  - C. The moral violation. This was a malicious act. My focus is on finding the person responsible and ensuring justice is served.
2. You look back on a period of intense personal growth. What is the clearest sign of your progress?
  - A. I have acquired new knowledge and can now understand complex systems I couldn't before.
  - B. I am more in tune with who I truly am, and my actions are more aligned with my core values.
  - C. I am physically healthier, my senses are sharper, and my gut instincts are more reliable.



3. What truly makes a house a "home"?

- A. It is a place of authentic self-expression, where I feel a true sense of belonging and purpose.
- B. It is a place of physical comfort, security, and sensory peace.
- C. It is an orderly and efficient space where the social dynamics are clear, fair, and logical.

4. You discover a trusted leader has been lying to the community. Which aspect of the betrayal cuts the deepest?

- A. The violation of a core principle. Honesty is fundamental, and they broke that sacred trust.
- B. The emotional manipulation and the hurt it has caused the people who believed in them.
- C. The logical breakdown. The system of trust was based on false data, meaning all subsequent decisions are flawed.

5. If you had to choose a metaphorical "weapon" to solve your problems, what would it be?

- A. A perfectly balanced hammer. A direct, physical tool for both building and breaking.
- B. A grand library. Access to all the world's information and the logic to use it.
- C. An inspiring symbol. An icon that represents my will and rallies others to my cause.

6. What frustrates you the most in others?

- A. Willful ignorance and illogical thinking.
- B. Hypocrisy and inauthenticity.
- C. Physical carelessness and a lack of situational awareness.

7. Which experience brings you the most profound sense of joy?

- A. A moment of deep, purposeful connection with another person or a cause.
- B. A thrilling physical experience that makes you feel alive and fully present in your body.
- C. The "eureka" moment when a complex problem suddenly becomes clear and you see the perfect solution.

8. When making a life-altering decision, what is your ultimate tie-breaker?

- A. My gut instinct and the physical sensations in my body.
- B. The hard data and a logical analysis of the potential outcomes.
- C. My unwavering moral compass and core principles.

9. The story of your life should be, above all, a story of...

- A. Intellectual contribution and the systems you helped build or improve.
- B. Unwavering character and the positive impact your will had on the world.
- C. Rich, visceral experiences and incredible physical feats.

## Section B: The Axis of Context (The Application)

This section explores how you prefer to apply yourself, whether you focus on core principles (Foundation), management and regulation (Control), or direct, hands-on action (Execution).

10. An ancient, powerful technology is discovered. What is your first order of business?

- A. Understand its core principles. We cannot use it until we understand the fundamental theory of why it works.
- B. Establish strict protocols. We must secure it, manage access, and monitor it to ensure it is handled safely.
- C. Test its functionality. The best way to learn is by doing. I would begin careful, hands-on experiments immediately.

11. You are tasked with building a highly effective team. What is the most critical component?

- A. A clear and disciplined operational structure with well-defined roles and rules of engagement.
- B. Recruiting the most skilled individuals and empowering them to execute their tasks with minimal interference.
- C. A shared, foundational vision and a powerful mission statement that everyone believes in.

12. Your community is facing a long, harsh winter. What is the most important preparation?

- A. Taking immediate action: gathering firewood, insulating homes, and hunting for food stores.
- B. Reinforcing our core values and the "why" of our community, to ensure our social fabric survives the hardship.
- C. Implementing a meticulous resource management plan: rationing food, scheduling work shifts, and monitoring supplies.

13. How do you prefer to learn a new, complex skill?

- A. By studying the fundamental theories and history behind it first.
- B. Through a disciplined regimen of practice, drills, and structured repetition.
- C. By jumping straight into a real-world project and learning by doing.

14. You must pass on your most valuable knowledge. What form does it take?

- A. A structured curriculum with clear lessons, exercises, and assessments to manage a student's progress.
- B. A hands-on apprenticeship where the student learns by actively working alongside me.
- C. A philosophical text that explains the core principles and the "why" behind the knowledge, allowing students to find their own way.

15. A community has fallen into disarray due to internal conflict. Where do you begin to fix it?

- A. Launch a high-visibility, practical project that gets everyone working together on a tangible goal to build momentum.
- B. Bring everyone together to re-establish their founding charter and remind them of the core principles they all agreed to.
- C. Mediate the conflicts, establish new rules of conduct, and manage the emotional state of the community.

16. Which of these represents true strength?

- A. Unshakable principles that you would never compromise.
- B. Disciplined self-mastery and control over one's impulses.
- C. The proven ability to execute a plan and achieve results.

17. Someone insults your core beliefs in a public setting. How do you respond?

- A. I de-escalate the situation, manage the emotional temperature of the room, and prevent further conflict.
- B. With a direct and immediate action, a witty comeback, a sharp counter-argument, or a challenge.
- C. I ignore the personal insult and instead defend the underlying principle that was attacked, explaining why it is important.

18. You are preparing for a long and dangerous journey. What is the most critical preparation?

- A. Getting a reliable map and taking the first step. The journey is the plan.
- B. Understanding the culture, history, and fundamental nature of the lands I will be passing through.
- C. Meticulous logistical planning: packing the right gear, managing supplies, and setting a sustainable pace.

## Section C: The Axis of Perspective (The Scope)

This section explores where your actions are primarily directed, whether your focus is on yourself (Internal), on another individual (External), or on the group (Collaborative).

19. Having mastered a rare and valuable skill, what brings you the most satisfaction?

- A. The quiet fulfillment of perfecting my own craft and deepening my personal understanding.
- B. Disseminating the knowledge to the world by teaching it to as many individuals as possible.
- C. Forming a new guild or institution with other experts to create something greater than the sum of our parts.

20. You receive an unexpected windfall of resources. What is your first instinct?

- A. Donate it to an important cause or a specific person who I know is in desperate need.
- B. Use it to fund a project that will benefit my entire community or team.
- C. Invest it in my own well-being, tools, and personal growth.

21. "Success" is ultimately measured by...

- A. The strength and prosperity of the group, team, or family I am a part of.
- B. The achievement of personal enlightenment and true self-mastery.
- C. The tangible, positive impact I have made on the wider world or on another individual's life.

22. You witness a gross injustice. How do you prefer to fight it?
- By directly confronting the perpetrator or providing immediate aid to the individual who was wronged.
  - By organizing a protest group or social movement to challenge the system that allowed the injustice to occur.
  - By refusing to participate in the unjust system myself and focusing on purifying my own actions to live as a better example.
23. When you need guidance on a difficult problem, where do you turn?
- Inward, to my own intuition and quiet contemplation.
  - Outward, to a one-on-one conversation with a single, trusted mentor or expert.
  - To my inner circle, for a group brainstorming session where we can all share our perspectives.
24. If you were to tell a grand story, what would it be about?
- The biography of a singular, great individual who changed the world through their actions.
  - The epic tale of a fellowship of heroes who achieved the impossible together.
  - An introspective journey of one person's quest for self-discovery and inner peace.
25. Your ultimate loyalty lies with...
- My own conscience and my unwavering personal principles.
  - A specific individual, a partner, a child, a leader, whom I have sworn to protect.
  - My community, my "crew," my people, the collective group as a whole.
26. When a team project you are on fails, what is your first internal question?
- "What external force or individual sabotaged our efforts?"
  - "How did we fail in our communication and teamwork?"
  - "What was my personal mistake in this process?"
27. What environment best recharges your energy?
- A deep and meaningful one-on-one conversation.
  - A lively party or a collaborative team event.
  - Quiet solitude for introspection and reflection.

## Part III: Scoring & Interpretation

### Step 1: Tally the Scores

Use the Scoring Key below to tally the participant's answers for each of the three axes.

Scoring Sheet:

- Axis I: MOTIVATION
  - Body: \_\_\_\_\_
  - Mind: \_\_\_\_\_
  - Essence: \_\_\_\_\_
- Axis II: CONTEXT

- Foundation: \_\_\_\_\_
- Control: \_\_\_\_\_
- Execution: \_\_\_\_\_
- Axis III: PERSPECTIVE
  - Internal: \_\_\_\_\_
  - External: \_\_\_\_\_
  - Collaborative: \_\_\_\_\_

#### Scoring Key:

- Part A: Motivation (Questions 1-9)
  - Q1: a) Mind, b) Body, c) Essence
  - Q2: a) Mind, b) Essence, c) Body
  - Q3: a) Essence, b) Body, c) Mind
  - Q4: a) Essence, b) Body, c) Mind
  - Q5: a) Body, b) Mind, c) Essence
  - Q6: a) Mind, b) Essence, c) Body
  - Q7: a) Essence, b) Body, c) Mind
  - Q8: a) Body, b) Mind, c) Essence
  - Q9: a) Mind, b) Essence, c) Body
- Part B: Context (Questions 10-18)
  - Q10: a) Foundation, b) Control, c) Execution
  - Q11: a) Control, b) Execution, c) Foundation
  - Q12: a) Execution, b) Foundation, c) Control
  - Q13: a) Foundation, b) Control, c) Execution
  - Q14: a) Control, b) Execution, c) Foundation
  - Q15: a) Execution, b) Foundation, c) Control
  - Q16: a) Foundation, b) Control, c) Execution
  - Q17: a) Control, b) Execution, c) Foundation
  - Q18: a) Execution, b) Foundation, c) Control
- Part C: Perspective (Questions 19-27)
  - Q19: a) Internal, b) External, c) Collaborative
  - Q20: a) External, b) Collaborative, c) Internal
  - Q21: a) Collaborative, b) Internal, c) External
  - Q22: a) External, b) Collaborative, c) Internal
  - Q23: a) Internal, b) External, c) Collaborative
  - Q24: a) External, b) Collaborative, c) Internal
  - Q25: a) Internal, b) External, c) Collaborative
  - Q26: a) External, b) Collaborative, c) Internal
  - Q27: a) External, b) Collaborative, c) Internal

## Step 2: Determine the Resonance Vector

For each axis, identify the category with the highest score. Write the three dominant traits together in the format below.

Participant's Resonance Vector: \_\_\_\_\_ / \_\_\_\_\_ / \_\_\_\_\_

(MOTIVATION) / (CONTEXT) / (PERSPECTIVE)



## Step 3: Derive the Primary Aura and Tenet

Use the dominant traits for Motivation and Context to find the participant's primary Aura Color and its governing Tenet from the list below.

- If Motivation is BODY:
  - and Context is Foundation: Green (Tenet of Sovereignty)
  - and Context is Control: Silver (Tenet of Absolution)
  - and Context is Execution: Yellow (Tenet of Presence)
- If Motivation is MIND:
  - and Context is Foundation: White (Tenet of Justice)
  - and Context is Control: Black (Tenet of Integrity)
  - and Context is Execution: Orange (Tenet of Growth)
- If Motivation is ESSENCE:
  - and Context is Foundation: Purple (Tenet of Self-Knowledge)
  - and Context is Control: Red (Tenet of Accountability)
  - and Context is Execution: Blue (Tenet of Autonomy)

Participant's Primary Aura: \_\_\_\_\_ Governing Tenet: \_\_\_\_\_

## Step 4: Present the Resonance Profile

Use the template below to deliver the final, narrative result to the participant.

"Your Resonance Vector is: (Read the 3-part vector).

Your primary Aura is (Color), governed by the Tenet of (Tenet Name).

This means you are a (Dominant Perspective) (Tenet Name). Your core drive originates from your (Dominant Motivation). You are most effective and comfortable when applying this drive through a lens of (Dominant Context). Your actions are most naturally directed in a (Dominant Perspective) scope, which defines how you interact with yourself, others, and the world."

## Appendix H: New Player Guide

### Step 1: The Conceptual Hook (First 30 minutes)

This is where you get player buy-in without ever showing them a rule.

- **Tool Used:** Appendix G: The Resonance Assessment.
- **How it Works:** You don't start with stats or rules. You start with a personality quiz. This is brilliant because it's engaging, non-threatening, and gets the players thinking about archetypes and motivations.
- **The Outcome:** At the end, each player has a "Resonance Vector" and a "Primary Aura" (a color like Green or Blue). This gives them an immediate, flavorful identity within the game's world. It's the perfect intuitive hook. "Oh, I'm a Green character. That means I'm about stability and sovereignty."

### Step 2: The Narrative Foundation

Now you connect their conceptual identity to a character's "why."

- **Tool Used:** Appendix F: The 5-Point Motivational Profile. (Optional, but powerful)
- **How it Works:** You can guide them through this process. "Okay, you're a Green character. Is your main goal Security? What's your method for achieving it? What philosophy do you fight against?" This helps them build a psychologically sound character whose motivations are clear.
- **The Outcome:** The player now has a character with a defined goal, method, and internal/external conflicts. This makes roleplaying much easier and informs all their future decisions.

### Step 3: The Mechanical Bridge

This is where you introduce the very first rule, directly linked to their identity.

- **Tool Used:** Choosing a Seed Keyword.
- **How it Works:** You say, "Based on everything we've discussed, your Aura, your motivations, look at this list of Keywords. Pick the one that best represents the core of your character." A player who chose "Security" might pick Sturdy. A player who focused on "Influence" might pick Charismatic.
- **The Outcome:** The player has now made their first mechanical choice, and it feels meaningful because it flows directly from the character concept they just built. They now have a "special power" that is uniquely theirs.

### Step 4: The Practical Lesson (The First Session)

Now you run the adventure, which is a masterclass in layered teaching.

- **Tool Used:** Appendix H: "The Longest Night" One-Shot Module.

- **How it Works:** The adventure is structured to introduce mechanics exactly when they are needed, in a grounded, realistic context that is easy for anyone to understand.
  - **Act I (The Blackout):** Teaches the absolute core of the game: Effort Roll (SR + Stat) vs. Target Number. The GM doesn't have to explain nine stats. They just ask, "The door is jammed. Are you trying to force it with your body (Brawn) or find a clever way to pry it (Technique)?" The player learns by doing something intuitive.
  - **Act II (The Neighborhood):** Teaches that the core mechanic isn't just for physical tasks. It introduces Social Clocks and shows how their Seed Keyword can be used in non-combat situations. This is crucial for teaching players to think creatively and not just in terms of "attack rolls."
  - **Act III (The Breaking Point):** Introduces stakes and pressure with the Threat Clock (a timer). It also subtly introduces the concept of Tags (a negative status effect from touching a live wire). This is the "final exam" of the basic rules, forcing teamwork and efficient decision-making.

## Step 5: The "Graduation" - The Awakening

This is the narrative and mechanical payoff that solidifies everything they've learned.

- **How it Works:** After overcoming the final challenge, their characters "Awaken." They become Level 1, their stats increase, and they get to choose three new keywords.
- **The Outcome:** This is a powerful moment. They feel a sense of achievement that is tied directly to their actions in the game. They now understand the core rules and have a small suite of abilities. They are now playing "effectively." They know how to assess a problem (physical, social), choose an approach (which stat to use), apply their unique abilities (Keywords), and work toward depleting a Clock.

## Appendix I: One-Shot Module - "The Longest Night"

The players, as themselves, must navigate a sudden, city-wide blackout. The challenges are mundane and logical, but the pressure of the situation and their own innate strengths will push them to the brink, culminating in a shared, transformative experience. This module is designed to teach the Resonance System's rules layer by layer in a grounded, realistic setting.

### Session Zero: The Setup

1. The Concept: The GM explains, "You are not playing a character; you are playing you. We're going to explore what happens when an extraordinary event happens to ordinary people. The choices you make should be what you would do."
2. The Seed Keyword: The GM says, "Everyone has a core trait, something that defines them. In this game, that is a 'Seed Keyword.' I want you to look at the list and choose one keyword that you feel represents a core part of your personality. Are you great at talking your way out of things? Maybe it's Charismatic. Are you the person who always seems to have a plan? Maybe it's Insightful. Are you incredibly stubborn and resilient? Sturdy or Survivor might fit. Briefly tell me why you chose it. This is your only special ability right now. It is important."
3. The Scene: The GM asks, "So, where are you all hanging out on this cool spring evening? It's about 9 PM. Are you at someone's apartment for game night? Watching a movie? Just chilling?" Let the players decide this. It's their first group decision.

### Act I: The Blackout (Teaching Layer 1: Simple Checks)

The Inciting Incident: The GM describes the moment: "The lights don't just go out; they die. There's a single, sharp click from the breaker box, and then... nothing. The hum of the fridge, the glow of your phone screens, the sound of traffic—all gone. You try your phones. No power, no reception. Not just dead batteries, but completely inert. It feels like every circuit in the city just ceased to exist."

Situation 1: Getting Out

- The Goal: The players decide to leave their apartment/house to see what's going on. The front door is a modern one with a magnetic lock, now completely seized without power.
- The Mechanics: This is a Barrier with a Task Clock of 5 and a Target Number (TN) of 8.
- GM's Role: "This mag-lock is dead weight, jamming the door shut. How are you going to force it? Are you trying to find a prybar in a closet? That's an Effort Roll using your Technique. Are you just putting your shoulder into it and trying to break the frame? That's Brawn. You need to accumulate 5 points of success against a difficulty of 8 to get this thing open."
- Narrative Grounding: The challenge isn't a magical seal; it's a realistic consequence of a power failure on modern infrastructure. This teaches the core mechanic (SR + Level + Stat) in a grounded, believable scenario. Players are encouraged to use their Seed Keyword conceptually. The Crafty player might suggest a novel way to apply leverage; the Brawler player might organize a powerful team effort.



## Act II: The Neighborhood (Teaching Layer 2: Investigation & Social Clocks)

**The Street Outside:** The scene is one of controlled chaos. There are no monsters, no strange lights. There are stalled cars causing traffic jams. People are out on the street, confused and anxious. Some are helping each other; others are arguing. The only light comes from the moon and a few old-fashioned emergency flares.

**Situation 2: Finding a Safe Haven**

- **The Goal:** The neighborhood feels unsafe. The players decide they need to get somewhere more secure with supplies, like the local community center or a hardware store a few blocks away. The problem is navigating the anxious crowd.
- **The Mechanics:** This is a Social Clock representing the Crowd's Tension. It starts at 10. To get through, they must reduce this clock to 0 by making successful social interactions. Failure has consequences.
- **Social Interactions:**
  - i. **The Panicked Neighbor:** A man is frantically trying to get into his car, shouting that he needs to get to his kids. He's blocking the way. The players need to calm him down. This is a Social Effort Roll vs TN 8. A player using Charismatic or Insightful would excel here. A success reduces the Tension Clock. A failure causes him to shout more, increasing the Tension Clock by 1.
  - ii. **The Looting Teenagers:** A small group of kids is trying to break the window of a convenience store. The players need to intervene—either by scaring them off, persuading them, or creating a distraction. This is a Social Effort Roll vs TN 10. A Brawler might intimidate them; a Trickster might create a diversion. Success reduces the Tension Clock.
  - iii. **The Community Organizer:** A woman with a megaphone is trying to direct people. The players can offer to help, lending their skills to the effort. This is a cooperative Effort Roll vs TN 9. Success here might reduce the Tension Clock by 2.
- **Narrative Grounding:** The obstacles are people, not monsters. The challenge is social and logistical. This teaches them about different kinds of clocks and how their keywords can apply to non-physical problems.

## Act III: The Breaking Point (Teaching Layers 2 & 3: High-Stakes Skill Challenge)

**The Destination:** The players reach their goal (e.g., the hardware store). But there's a problem: a car has crashed into the front, damaging the main gas line. The air is thick with the smell of gas, and sparks are coming from a downed power line nearby. It's a bomb waiting to happen.

**Situation 3: Avert the Disaster**

- **The Goal:** They must secure the area before they can safely get inside. This is a timed, high-stakes skill challenge.
- **The Mechanics:** This is a Race Situation, but without combat. It introduces the Threat Clock, which starts at 10. It ticks down by 1 at the end of every "round" of actions. If it hits 0, the gas ignites.
- **The Tasks (Two separate Micro-Clocks):**
  - i. **Shut Off the Gas Main (Task Clock 6, TN 10):** The valve is old, rusted, and hard to turn. It will require focused Effort Rolls (using Brawn for force, Technique for skill). Each attempt takes one person's full turn.
  - ii. **Isolate the Power Line (Task Clock 4, TN 12):** The line is live and sparking. Someone needs to find a non-conductive object (a long wooden plank, a



rubber mat) and use it to push the line away from the gas leak. This requires a delicate Effort Roll (using Technique or Wit). A failure means the character gains the Impair (Silver) Tag as they jolt their muscles from a near-miss with the electricity.

- Narrative Grounding: This is the climax. The threat is real, physical, and immediate. The players are forced to work together under immense pressure. They must use their actions efficiently and decide who is best for each task. The Daze or Impair tags they might suffer aren't magical curses; they are the realistic results of physical strain and near-accidents.

The Climax: The Awakening As the final clock is depleted—the gas is shut off, the wire is moved—the players collapse in relief. In that shared moment of extreme stress, adrenaline, and success, something clicks.

The GM describes: "As you catch your breath, the scent of gas fading, the world seems to... sharpen. It's not a sound or a light. It's a feeling. A sudden, profound understanding. You can feel the potential energy in the silent power line, the kinetic force you exerted on the valve, the bond of trust between all of you. It's like you were colorblind your whole life and just saw red for the first time. The rules of the world haven't changed, but you can suddenly read the source code."

The Reward & Hooks:

- Each player is now Level 1.
- All their stats become a new baseline of 2.
- They each learn three new keywords, which they can choose now.
- The city's power returns. Everything seems normal... except for them.
- Hooks for a Campaign: What was the true cause of the blackout? Was it a natural phenomenon, a test, or an attack? Are there others who Awakened? Are there things out there now drawn to their newfound power? The world is now their oyster.